

FREE WILL AS ADMISSIBLE COMMITMENT

Standing, Constraint Bundles, and Responsibility Without Outcome Selection

Amos Jay Maley 20 June 2026

***Thesis.** Free will is the standing-bound capacity for admissible authored uptake of a determinate constraint bundle. It is **free** when the bearer-bundle-carrier relation is valid, non-displaced, non-laundered, non-post-selected, and carrier-adequate within the indexed domain. It is **will** when the standing bearer adopts the bundle as its own commitment object. Commitment is the historically irreversible fixation of that uptake; responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation; causal realization and outcome remain downstream.*

Abstract

This paper gives the AASC answer to free will. The account is revisionary rather than semantically conservative: it does not preserve free will as metaphysical spontaneity, uncaused causation, outcome-control, branch selection, or exemption from determinism. It identifies the responsibility-authorship role that free-will discourse must supply when invoked to ground commitment, consent, answerability, excuse, blame, liability, or accountability under constraint.

The paper separates directed uptake from authorship before deriving the answer. **Directed uptake** is a bearer-directed adoption, authorization, undertaking, or refusal with respect to a determinate bundle; it can be described without presupposing that the token is authored or free. **Indexed authorship occupancy** is the independently testable relation in which an eligible standing bearer has identity-relevant access to that bundle, manifests uptake through an adequate carrier, binds within the admissible envelope, and is not displaced by another author. **Authored uptake** is directed uptake that satisfies those authorship conditions. A bundle is the bearer's "own" only in this relational, indexed sense; no psychological enthusiasm, ultimate sourcehood, or proprietary title is implied.

The decomposition gives positive AASC content to both terms. **Will** is authored uptake of a determinate bundle. **Free** is valid, non-displaced occupancy of the indexed authorship relation under standing and admissibility, not absence of causation or constraint. **Free will** is the standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the conditions for admissible indexed authorship and become fixed as commitment. **Commitment** is the historically irreversible fixation of that uptake into a responsibility-bearing relation.

Responsibility-authorship attaches at commitment, not at outcome. Standing supplies author eligibility; directed uptake supplies the bearer-directed token; indexed authorship occupancy supplies the author relation; commitment supplies fixation; responsibility-authorship supplies the bearer-bundle attachment; and downstream causation supplies implementation and outcome. These roles are non-identical, and the added vocabulary is not ad hoc: each term isolates a function that ordinary free-will discourse otherwise collapses.

The result is conditional and substantive. Given canonical standing, bivalent structural admissibility, determinate bundle identity, adequate carriers, historical irreversibility, and no post-selection repair, the free-will role relevant to responsibility-authorship cannot be occupied by randomness, alternative availability, causal openness, social reaction, or outcome success. None supplies the complete eligible-bearer, directed-uptake, authored-object, carrier, fixation, and historical-stability relation. Admissible indexed authorship fixed by commitment does.

The account does not derive retributive desert, punishment, blame, compensation, forgiveness, or legal liability. Every action-directed desert or response theory nevertheless requires an authorship target or an expressly non-authorship basis. Automation remains a limited delegation stress test and is not the paper's focus.

The result preserves authorship while rejecting outcome-control. Free will survives in AASC as the standing-bound capacity for valid, non-displaced authored uptake; commitment fixes that uptake; responsibility attaches at fixation; causation, outcome, luck, branching, execution, desert, sanction, and institutional response remain downstream.

Keywords: AASC; free will; admissible commitment; directed uptake; indexed authorship; authored uptake; standing; responsibility-authorship; determinism; branching; constraint bundle; commitment carrier; coercion; agency under constraint; no post-selection repair.

Scope and Claim Discipline

This paper presents the AASC answer to free will within a declared domain of responsibility-authorship. It does not claim that every historical or ordinary-language use of “free will” names the same object. It does claim that the responsibility-authorship function traditionally assigned to free will requires a stable bearer, a determinate object, a directed uptake token, an adequate carrier, a binding event, and independence from retrospective outcome repair. The central exhaustion result is conditional on the primitives stated in Part II and limited to that same-scope function. Its conditional form is affirmative: if responsibility-authorship is standing-governed, admissibility-bound, historically stable, and protected from post-selection repair, then free will cannot be outcome-selection.

Three boundaries are fixed from the outset. First, standing is a canonical primitive in this treatment; the paper distinguishes standing from free will and derives consequences from standing, but it does not supply a complete naturalistic theory of which entities possess it. Second, responsibility-authorship is prior to blame, sanction, desert, compensation, and legal liability; those responses require further normative and institutional premises. Third, internal AASC corpus dependencies support the construction but do not substitute for the argument.

Terminological scope is strict. **Admissible is not a synonym for moral** permission, legal authorization, prudence, or approval. **Irreversible is historical rather than perpetual:** later revocation or supersession can change continuing force without erasing the original token. **Directed uptake** records bearer-directed adoption without yet attributing authorship. **Authored uptake** is the directed token once the independently specified authorship conditions are satisfied. **Will** names that

authored uptake, not desire, intention, phenomenology, or causal selection. **Free** names valid, non-displaced indexed authorship occupancy, not absence of constraint. **Commitment fixes uptake**, and free will does not select outcomes.

The manuscript's vocabulary is deliberately decompositional. Standing, directed uptake, indexed authorship occupancy, carrier, bundle, fixation, responsibility, causation, outcome, and response answer different questions. Their separation is required to prevent the conclusion from being hidden in a premise and to prevent downstream outcomes from rewriting authorship.

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Part I - Orientation and Problem Diagnosis

1. Introduction: Role Collapse and the Responsibility-Authorship Target

1.1 One word, incompatible jobs

The historical free-will problem is often presented as a dispute over whether human beings possess one contested property. That presentation assumes too much unity in the target. In practice, "free will" is asked to do at least seven jobs. It distinguishes agents from non-agents; marks the point at which conduct becomes attributable; explains how action enters the causal order; secures the ability to do otherwise; grounds praise, blame, liability, or answerability; expresses first-person sourcehood; and sometimes explains why one possible future rather than another becomes actual.

These functions need not coincide. A capacity is not an event. An event is not its causal history. A causal history is not a responsibility relation. A responsibility relation is not a sanction. A felt experience of deciding is not yet a public commitment object. A space of alternatives does not identify which alternative a bearer became answerable for. Treating these roles as one object makes the criteria migrate whenever a standard objection appears.

When determinism threatens causal independence, an account may move to acting on one's desires. When manipulation threatens desire-based accounts, it may move to historical ownership or reasons-responsiveness. When alternative possibilities disappear, it may move to actual-sequence control. When luck changes consequences, it may move between intention and outcome. Each move can illuminate a different question, but the target changes while the term remains fixed. AASC begins by refusing that migration.

1.2 The neutral target role

Before defining free will, the paper isolates the work that a theory of responsibility-bearing agency must perform. Let **R** denote the following neutral target:

***Responsibility-Authorship Target R.** R is the minimum responsibility-authorship structure that (i) identifies an eligible author, (ii) identifies a determinate object attributable to that author, (iii) identifies the event at which the author-object relation becomes fixed, (iv) preserves that historical relation against retrospective outcome repair, and (v) distinguishes authorship from causal implementation and institutional response.*

Definition FW-D00 - Responsibility-authorship target. The responsibility-authorship target is the same-scope role that identifies who can author a responsibility-bearing object, what object is authored, when authorship attaches, and how that attachment remains distinct from outcome realization.

R is deliberately neutral among traditional theories. It does not presuppose libertarian causation, compatibilist control, alternative possibilities, reasons-responsiveness, phenomenological authorship, or a practice-based account. It states the minimum structural burden any such view must carry if it is to support stable attribution. This ordering blocks the charge that AASC first invents a definition and then declares it victorious. The target is specified before the proposed occupant.

The target also explains why free will matters in this paper. If no object can occupy R, responsibility-bearing attribution lacks a stable author or object. If several objects can occupy R without contradiction, AASC has not exhausted the role. The argument must therefore show both adequacy - that admissible commitment performs every function of R - and exclusion - that same-scope rivals either omit a function, import an illicit selector, collapse roles, or change the domain.

1.3 Why R is the correct AASC target for free will

The neutrality of R does not mean that every use of "free will" must reduce to R. Some uses concern first-person phenomenology, theological accountability, metaphysical origination, creativity, spontaneity, or the subjective experience of deliberation. AASC does not deny that those questions are meaningful. It denies that they can perform responsibility-bearing work merely by retaining the label "free will."

R is the correct AASC target because free-will discourse becomes action-guiding and institutionally consequential when it is invoked to answer questions such as: Who authored this undertaking? What was the person or institution bound to? When did responsibility attach? Was the act coerced, forged, misunderstood, or displaced? Did later success, failure, or harm change who authored the earlier commitment? These questions require an author, an object, a fixation event, and historical stability. A theory that supplies only conscious experience, causal openness, alternative possibilities, or social reaction leaves one or more of those objects unidentified.

Four tests discipline the target.

1. **Indispensability:** remove the bearer, object, fixation event, or stable relation and responsibility-authorship becomes indeterminate.
2. **Same-scope neutrality:** R does not decide in advance whether its occupant is libertarian, compatibilist, psychological, social, legal, or AASC-native.

3. **Minimality:** R contains only what stable responsibility-attribution requires; it does not build in blame, punishment, desert, or outcome control.
4. **Non-migration:** a proposed theory must occupy the same target across determinism, branching, coercion, ignorance, and luck rather than changing criteria case by case.

Lemma FW-L01 - Responsibility-Authorship Target Adequacy. Whenever free will is invoked to ground responsibility-bearing authorship, the invoked theory must supply an eligible bearer, a determinate authored object, a fixation event, historical stability, and separation from causal execution and later response. A view that omits one of these functions has not yet occupied the AASC free-will target R.

The lemma is conditional on the responsibility-bearing use of free will. It does not assert that all speech about freedom is secretly legal or institutional. It identifies the role without which free will cannot support promise, consent, refusal, answerability, blame, liability, excuse, forgiveness, or commitment. Once that scope is fixed, merely supplying a vivid experience of choosing or a causally open future is insufficient.

1.4 The free-will/responsibility bridge

AASC must avoid two opposite collapses. It must not identify free will with responsibility, because a capacity is not the relation produced by its exercise. It must also avoid treating free will as wholly detached from responsibility, because then the reason for targeting free will disappears. The bridge is functional and ordered.

- Standing supplies eligibility for the author role.
- Free will supplies the capacity condition for admissible authorship.
- Commitment is the exercise event through which the capacity becomes binding.
- Responsibility-authorship is the bearer-bundle relation fixed by that event.
- Blame, liability, desert, excuse, forgiveness, and sanction are later evaluative or institutional layers.

Theorem FW-T23 - Free-Will/Responsibility Bridge. In an AASC-governed domain, free will enters as the capacity condition for responsibility-authorship. A theory that cannot identify the standing bearer, admissible object, commitment event, and historically stable responsibility relation has not supplied the relevant AASC free-will role.

Proof. Responsibility-authorship requires a bearer capable of being bound to a determinate object. Mere causation supplies an event sequence but not an eligible author. Mere outcome supplies a consequence but not the prior authored bundle. Alternative possibility supplies an envelope property but not the actual fixation relation. Randomness supplies causal openness but not standing or

uptake. Social reaction supplies a response but can be mistaken or misdirected. The missing capacity is the standing-bound capacity to author an admissible commitment. When exercised through a valid carrier, that capacity fixes responsibility-authorship. Therefore free will is prior to responsibility but not identical with it. **QED.**

This bridge answers the charge that the manuscript changes subjects from free will to attribution. The paper does not claim that responsibility exhausts every meaning of free will. It claims that the AASC-admissible free-will role is the capacity required for commitment-based responsibility. Any richer account may add phenomenology, psychology, or normative theory, but it must still either supply R or explain why responsibility-bearing authorship needs no stable target.

1.5 The AASC reconstruction

The reconstruction uses seven non-equivalent objects:

- **Standing** identifies eligibility to occupy the author role.
- **Will** is the standing bearer's authored uptake of a determinate admissible bundle as its own commitment object.
- **Free** marks the validity of that uptake: non-displaced, non-laundered, non-post-selected, carrier-adequate, and not defeated by a constitutive defect.
- **Free will** is the standing-bound capacity for such admissible authored uptake.
- **Commitment** is the historically irreversible fixation of authored uptake.
- **Responsibility-authorship** is the bearer-bundle relation fixed by commitment.
- **Causation** is the physical, psychological, social, computational, or institutional evolution in which carriers arise and outcomes unfold.

The free-will capacity does not itself push matter, collapse alternatives, allocate probabilities, or choose an actual branch. A physical or institutional realization of uptake and commitment can have causes and effects. A signature may cause an account to open; an order may cause subordinates to act; a neural and bodily process may realize an undertaking. None of those causal pathways is identical to the standing bearer's authored adoption of the bundle or to the responsibility relation fixed by commitment.

This role/realizer distinction prevents two opposite errors. If free will is called non-causal without qualification, authored uptake can appear epiphenomenal. If the effects of a carrier are attributed to free will as such, an extra selector re-enters. The AASC claim is exact: no additional causal force called free will is needed to explain outcome realization. Authored uptake and responsibility-authorship are instantiated through causal realizers without being identical to them.

Proposition FW-T24 - Conditional Form of the AASC Result. Given canonical standing, bivalent structural admissibility, determinate bundle identity, historically irreversible fixation, and no post-selection repair, the free-will role relevant to responsibility-authorship cannot be occupied by outcome-control, alternative availability, randomness, social reaction, or metaphysical causal exception. It is occupied by the standing-bound capacity for admissible authored uptake, fixed by commitment.

Argument. Outcome-control and randomness describe realization rather than an eligible author. Alternative availability describes an envelope rather than the actual bearer-object relation. Social reaction is temporally downstream and can be mistaken. Metaphysical causal exception adds a selector without supplying standing, bundle identity, carrier adequacy, uptake, or fixation. Admissible authored uptake supplies the positive will condition; non-defective and non-displaced uptake supplies the positive free condition; commitment supplies fixation. The proposition does not derive the AASC primitives; it states what follows from them and exposes the exact premise burden of dissent.

The conditional form should therefore be read as the theory's rigor. A critic may reject standing, bivalence, irreversibility, no-repair discipline, authored uptake, or target R. What the critic may not do is retain those constraints while reintroducing an outcome selector under another name.

1.6 Master thesis

This paper gives the AASC answer to free will. It does not defend libertarian outcome-selection, metaphysical spontaneity, uncaused agency, or exemption from causation. Nor does it reduce responsibility to downstream result. It argues that the admissible role historically assigned to free will is exhausted by the standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the conditions for admissible indexed authorship and become fixed as commitment.

A standing bearer is not free because it causes an unconstrained future. It is free in the AASC sense when it validly and non-displacedly occupies the indexed authorship relation for a determinate bundle. It wills when a bearer-directed token satisfies those authorship conditions and thereby becomes authored uptake. Commitment fixes that uptake. Responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation. Outcomes, consequences, causal evolution, branching, luck, desert, sanction, and execution remain downstream.

Free will is the standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the conditions for admissible indexed authorship and become fixed as commitment. Commitment is the historically irreversible fixation of valid authored uptake. Responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation. Outcomes are downstream.

Five qualifications prevent overstatement.

First, **admissible** is not a synonym for moral, lawful, or wise. An admissible commitment can be wicked, illegal, imprudent, or mistaken. Admissibility asks whether a candidate can enter the responsibility-bearing construction without violating standing, scope, coherence, or fixation discipline.

Second, **free** is not a scalar remainder left after constraint is removed. It is the positive relational status of valid, non-displaced authorship occupancy under the declared conditions. Evidence can be graded; the indexed token is valid or defective.

Third, **will** is not desire, intention, phenomenology, or causal power. Directed uptake can be described before any authorship verdict. Will is present only when that token satisfies the independently specified authorship conditions.

Fourth, **irreversible** is historical rather than perpetual. A commitment can be revoked, amended, superseded, excused, forgiven, discharged, or rendered unenforceable. What cannot occur is the later conversion of the original valid commitment into a historical non-event merely because its consequences became inconvenient.

Fifth, **responsibility** in the central theorem means responsibility-authorship. It does not by itself settle blameworthiness, retributive desert, damages, punishment, forgiveness, compensation, or treatment.

1.7 What is eliminated and what is preserved

The account eliminates an uncaused causal power added to the world, a selector of outcome actuality, a pre-admissible scalar of freedom, a power to enlarge the envelope merely by willing, and a retrospective power to revise authorship by appeal to success, failure, luck, or regret.

It preserves the functions R requires: author eligibility, authored uptake, object identity, a fixation point, separation of authorship from delegated execution, and stable attribution across downstream causal regimes. The result is eliminative about metaphysical outcome-control but preservative about responsibility-bearing agency. It gives positive AASC content to both terms: **will** is authored bundle-adoption and **free** is valid, non-displaced uptake under constraint. It is neither conventional compatibilism nor simple skeptical denial. It changes the object while preserving the work.

1.8 Contribution and novelty boundary

Related ideas appear separately throughout the literature. Actual-sequence theories shift attention away from alternatives; hierarchical accounts distinguish desire from endorsement; reasons-responsive accounts analyze control; planning theories emphasize policy and diachronic

organization; legal doctrines distinguish capacity, intent, causation, and excuse. The present paper does not claim that each component is unprecedented. Its novelty claim is configurational and theorem-level: standing, admissibility, constraint bundles, carrier adequacy, historically irreversible commitment, no post-selection repair, and responsibility attachment are ordered into one exhaustion argument.

The relevant novelty burden is therefore not "no one has said anything similar." It is whether the exact construction, its premises, its derived consequences, and its nearest rivals are stated transparently enough to be challenged. The paper supplies explicit failure conditions and a same-scope counterexample burden for that purpose.

1.9 Method

The paper proceeds in six stages. First, it identifies the AASC target role for free will and proves the free-will/responsibility bridge. Second, it declares standing, admissibility, envelope, bundle, carrier, fixation, and no-repair conditions. Third, it derives the core theorem chain and the conditional exhaustion result. Fourth, it compares AASC with compatibilism, libertarian sourcehood, reasons-responsiveness, hierarchical endorsement, planning agency, reactive-attitude theory, and skepticism. Fifth, it applies the structure to determinism, branching, Frankfurt cases, coercion, manipulation, ignorance, incapacity, law, institutions, and a limited automation stress test. Sixth, it states what would count as a same-scope refutation.

The method is structural rather than experimental. Empirical evidence remains necessary to decide whether a real bearer understood a bundle, whether a carrier was authentic, whether coercion occurred, or whether institutional authorization was valid. The theory does not replace those inquiries. It identifies the exact predicates they must establish.

1.10 What the paper does not need to prove - and what it must prove

The AASC answer does not need to prove that agents are uncaused causes, that consciousness selects outcomes, that indeterminism improves responsibility, that agents authored their entire causal history, that every valid commitment deserves punishment, that positive law perfectly tracks standing, that subjective experience is irrelevant, that artificial systems possess or lack standing, or that every ordinary use of "free will" reduces to one concept. Requiring any of those results would change the paper's declared target.

The paper does have four non-negotiable burdens. It must show that responsibility-authorship requires a capacity condition; that this capacity is not identical to causation, outcome-selection, randomness, or social response; that standing-bound admissible commitment supplies a bearer,

object, carrier, fixation event, and stable relation; and that determinism, branching, luck, and ordinary causal formation do not defeat the relation unless they generate a specified validity failure.

This boundary is not a retreat from the free-will problem. It prevents excluded metaphysical ambitions from being reintroduced as unstated success criteria. AASC answers the responsibility-bearing free-will question on its own declared scope and states the conditions under which that answer would fail.

1.11 Reader's map

The paper has one governing line of argument. Sections 1-2 diagnose role collapse, identify target R, and locate the AASC answer against the principal free-will traditions. Sections 3-4 declare the primitives and distinguish action, intention, commitment, and execution. Sections 5-10 derive the core theorem chain and same-scope exhaustion result. Sections 11-13 test determinism, branching, and Frankfurt-style cases. Sections 14-18 apply the validity conditions to incapacity, coercion, manipulation, ignorance, and concrete cases. Sections 19-21 separate authorship from desert and institutional response while keeping automation tangential. Section 22 states the philosophical changes produced by the reconstruction. Sections 23-30 answer objections; Sections 31-34 specify failure and refutation conditions and close with the final AASC theorem.

The appendices provide the formal ledger, adjudicated case architecture, corpus dependency map, and supporting audit trail. None substitutes for the argument in the main text.

2. The Standard Dialectic and the AASC Reclassification

The neighboring literature supplies important distinctions, but no neighboring view is treated as an AASC premise. Each comparator is assessed by the same four questions: what does it contribute, what does AASC preserve, what does AASC reject, and why can it not occupy R alone? This method prevents caricature while preserving the independence of the AASC construction.

2.1 Compatibilism: a neighboring conclusion, a different route

Compatibilism denies that determinism alone excludes free will or responsibility. Classical and contemporary versions identify freedom with such features as unimpeded action, acting from one's motives, hierarchical endorsement, reasons-responsiveness, or guidance control (Frankfurt 1971; Watson 1975; Fischer and Ravizza 1998; Wallace 1994). AASC reaches a result that can look compatibilist - responsibility survives determinism - but it does not reach that result by proving that determined causation counts as a special kind of outcome control.

The difference is architectural. Compatibilist accounts generally retain free will as a control condition within the actual causal sequence. AASC relocates responsibility-bearing work to the relation among standing, bundle, carrier, and commitment event. Causal control can be evidentially or normatively relevant without being identical to that relation. Reasons-responsiveness may support access; hierarchical endorsement may support uptake; absence of compulsion may support carrier adequacy. None by itself fixes the bearer-bundle relation.

Accordingly, AASC accepts that causal determination is not automatically exculpating, that actual-sequence features matter, and that compulsion differs from ordinary causation. It rejects the need to call the relevant relation control of outcomes. The result is **determinism invariance through role separation**: compatibilist-looking in conclusion, structurally distinct in method.

2.2 Libertarian sourcehood: preserve authorship, reject causal inflation

Libertarian theories insist that free agency is incompatible with determinism and therefore requires indeterministic event causation, agent causation, or another form of ultimate sourcehood (Chisholm 1964; Kane 1996; O'Connor 2000; Clarke 2003). Their strongest insight is that responsibility requires conduct to be attributable to the agent rather than merely happen through the agent. AASC preserves this concern as authorship. It rejects the inference that authorship must be an additional physical selector.

If indeterministic fluctuation determines which movement occurs, the fluctuation is not a standing bearer and does not bind itself to a bundle. If agent causation means a primitive power to originate one outcome rather than another outside ordinary causal explanation, it imports the selector AASC excludes. If "agent cause" means only that an action is attributable to a standing bearer through a valid commitment, the phrase redescribes the AASC relation without adding causal work.

Lemma FW-L10 - Libertarian Authorship Conversion. The authorship intuition motivating libertarianism is preserved in AASC only after it is relocated from outcome-production to admissible commitment-binding. Indeterministic openness or agent-causal vocabulary cannot alone supply standing, bundle identity, carrier adequacy, or fixation.

Charitable concession. Libertarian theories correctly preserve the intuition that passive event-production is insufficient for responsibility and that the bearer must author something. AASC preserves sourcehood in a bounded form: the bearer is the source of authored uptake and commitment, not the metaphysical source of the entire world-history or the physical selector of one future.

2.3 Hard determinism, basic-desert skepticism, and ultimate sourcehood

Hard determinists and free-will skeptics challenge the control or sourcehood required for basic-desert responsibility. Pereboom's hard incompatibilism is deliberately independent of whether determinism is true: deterministic histories threaten sourcehood, but event-causal indeterminism does not improve matters because luck cannot supply the control required for basic desert (Pereboom 2001, 2014). Manipulation cases press the point by constructing agents whose internal deliberation and reasons-responsive organization appear intact while the history producing those states seems to undermine responsibility. Caruso extends this skeptical pressure into punishment theory, arguing that retributive justification requires a form of free will and desert that we have insufficient reason to affirm, while defending forward-looking alternatives (Caruso 2021).

Charitable concession. Hard skeptics correctly expose the weakness of ultimate self-creation, luck-based freedom, and inflated basic-desert claims. AASC preserves three skeptical insights. First, no agent authors its total causal history or creates itself *ex nihilo*. Second, causal openness is not authorship: replacing determinism with chance does not generate standing, uptake, or bundle identity. Third, responsibility-authorship cannot by itself yield retributive desert. Those concessions are structural, not rhetorical.

AASC rejects the further inference from the absence of ultimate sourcehood to the absence of every authorship relation. Target R does not require an agent to be the source of the laws, the envelope, its inherited character, or the causal conditions of deliberation. It requires an eligible bearer to access and take up a determinate bundle through an adequate carrier without displacement. The skeptic may directly challenge those conditions. A manipulator may replace uptake; addiction may impair access; an institutional fiction may misassign standing. But the skeptic must identify the failed relation rather than infer non-authorship from causation as such.

This difference matters for Pereboom-style manipulation sequences. AASC does not say that all cases satisfying a favored compatibilist psychology are therefore authored. It traces the actual bearer-bundle-carrier relation. Direct implantation can fail V2, V3, V4, or V6. Ordinary causal formation need not. The gradation from engineered manipulation to ordinary development is therefore not handled by an intuition that causal abnormality fades; it is handled by identifying whether displacement, bypass, or bundle substitution persists.

The downstream relation to Caruso is equally precise. An AASC-valid authorship object does not entail retributivism. A public-health, restorative, protective, consequentialist, or skeptical response can be layered on top, provided it does not pretend that response itself created the prior authorship relation. Conversely, skepticism about basic desert does not show that promises, authorizations, refusals, or risk commitments lack authors.

Lemma FW-L11 - Ultimate-Source Non-Requirement. Responsibility-authorship does not require self-creation, authorship of one's total causal history, or metaphysical origination of the constraint envelope. It requires that a standing bearer validly author the commitment bundle at issue. Skepticism about basic desert is therefore compatible with, but does not entail the negation of, AASC responsibility-authorship.

The dialectical pressure on AASC is now exact: either show that target R illegitimately isolates authorship from desert, or show that determined and ordinarily formed commitments systematically fail a validity condition. Merely restating that the bearer did not create itself does neither.

2.4 Frankfurt, alternative possibilities, and actual authorship

The Principle of Alternative Possibilities links responsibility to the ability to do otherwise. Frankfurt's 1969 challenge constructs cases in which a counterfactual intervener would prevent deviation but remains inactive because the agent acts in the desired way. The intuitive lesson is not that alternatives never matter. It is that the absence of an available alternative need not explain the actual action and therefore need not erase responsibility for the actual sequence (Frankfurt 1969).

Charitable concession. Frankfurt-style cases correctly show that alternative possibilities are not always the true locus of responsibility. AASC preserves that actual-sequence insight while relocating its object. Alternative possibilities are features of an envelope, model, or counterfactual structure. They can matter to deliberation, coercion, excuse, evidence of access, and institutional fairness. They do not by themselves identify who authored the actual bundle, what that bundle was, or when the relation became fixed. A rich envelope can coexist with no commitment; a narrow envelope can coexist with a valid commitment.

The Frankfurt distinction becomes a source-tracing distinction. An **inactive blocker** removes or would remove alternatives but does not supply the actual uptake, bundle, or carrier. An **active intervener** replaces one of those constitutive elements. In the first case, alternative removal and authorship come apart; in the second, authorship is displaced. This is stronger than simply saying that actual-sequence control suffices, because the AASC result does not depend on redescribing causal control. It depends on the integrity of the bearer-bundle-carrier relation.

Frankfurt's later hierarchical account adds a different insight: a person's will can be evaluated through higher-order identification rather than by first-order desire alone (Frankfurt 1971). AASC treats such identification as evidence of uptake, alienation, or compulsion, not as the whole free-will role. Wholeheartedness without standing or a carrier does not fix responsibility; mixed motivation does not automatically invalidate an otherwise authentic commitment.

The decisive question is therefore not the modal slogan "could the bearer have done otherwise?" It is the indexed historical question "did this standing bearer author this bundle through this carrier, or did another source replace the authorship relation?" Sections 13 and 18 test that distinction in both inactive and active intervention cases.

2.5 Fischer and Ravizza: guidance control and reasons-responsive mechanisms

Fischer and Ravizza develop an actual-sequence account centered on **guidance control**. In broad terms, the behavior-producing mechanism must be the agent's own and must display an appropriate, moderate responsiveness to reasons (Fischer and Ravizza 1998). This is a sophisticated attempt to secure responsibility without requiring regulative control over alternative possibilities. It also treats historical ownership of the mechanism as important, thereby responding to manipulation and bypass worries.

Charitable concession. Fischer and Ravizza correctly identify actual-sequence sensitivity to reasons and historical mechanism ownership as important conditions of responsible agency. AASC preserves the explanatory value of all three elements. Reasons-responsiveness can support V2 by showing that a bearer can discriminate identity-relevant features of a bundle. It can support V3 by showing that uptake is sensitive to reasons rather than accidental. Mechanism ownership can supply evidence relevant to V6, because a process that has been bypassed, implanted, or commandeered may not be the bearer's operative carrier. Guidance control can also help distinguish ordinary causal realization from compulsion.

The AASC objection is one of sufficiency and object identity, not dismissal. A moderately reasons-responsive mechanism does not itself identify the responsibility object. It can issue in many acts under many descriptions, operate in a non-standing system, generate advice rather than commitment, or remain reasons-responsive when no commitment carrier has fixed a bearer-bundle relation. Likewise, calling a mechanism "the agent's own" requires a criterion of ownership; AASC asks whether that ownership includes standing, authentic uptake, and non-displacement for the specific bundle at issue.

This creates a translation rather than a rivalry. Fischer-Ravizza conditions answer how a responsible mechanism may track reasons and belong to an agent. AASC conditions answer when that mechanism's operation becomes a historically fixed commitment attributable to a standing bearer. The former can provide powerful evidence for the latter, but it does not replace the carrier and fixation point.

Consider a medical decision-support system that is highly responsive to reasons. Its mechanism may revise recommendations under counterfactual information, yet the clinician or institution may

retain standing and commitment authority. Conversely, a standing bearer can make a valid promise through a simple carrier without exhibiting a complex counterfactual profile at the moment of promise, because a prior policy or settled understanding supplies the relevant access. These cases show that responsiveness and authorship can vary independently.

Lemma FW-L06 - Reasons-Responsiveness Insufficiency. Reasons-responsiveness and guidance control may explain or evidence access, uptake, mechanism ownership, and carrier integrity, but they do not by themselves bind a standing bearer to a determinate admissible bundle. They therefore cannot alone occupy target R.

In authored-uptake terms, reasons-responsiveness can support access, carrier reliability, and the stability of directed uptake, but it does not itself supply indexed authorship occupancy or fixation.

The AASC pressure test for a reasons-responsive account is straightforward: identify the bearer, the bundle, the carrier, the fixation event, and the rule that prevents outcome-based redescription. If those objects are supplied, the account has approached admissible commitment; if they are absent, mechanism sensitivity remains incomplete as a theory of responsibility-authorship.

2.6 Hierarchical endorsement

Hierarchical accounts distinguish first-order desires from higher-order endorsement, identification, or volitional ownership (Frankfurt 1971; Watson 1975). Their contribution is a language for alienation: an agent may experience a desire without endorsing it as governing conduct.

AASC preserves higher-order endorsement as evidence of uptake and as a tool for diagnosing compulsion, ambivalence, or manipulation. It rejects endorsement as a complete free-will object. An endorsed target may be incoherent or inadmissible. Endorsement may remain private and never become a responsibility-bearing carrier. A person may validly commit despite mixed feelings, while a fully wholehearted desire may lack institutional authority or bundle identity.

Lemma FW-L07 - Hierarchical-Endorsement Insufficiency. Higher-order endorsement can support uptake, but endorsement without standing, an admissible bundle, an adequate carrier, and fixation does not attach responsibility-authorship.

AASC therefore converts hierarchy into evidence for or against directed uptake and indexed authorship occupancy; it does not treat psychic hierarchy as the free-will role itself. Higher-order endorsement may reveal uptake, but it neither constitutes authorship nor fixes commitment by category alone.

2.7 Bratman: planning agency and diachronic commitment

Bratman's planning theory treats future-directed intentions as elements of partial plans that organize practical reasoning, coordinate conduct over time, constrain reconsideration, and support social coordination (Bratman 1987). This contribution is indispensable for any theory that would otherwise reduce agency to isolated choice-points. Human action is often governed by standing policies, projects, intentions, and shared plans; the relevant authorship may be fixed well before a later bodily movement.

Charitable concession. Bratman correctly identifies planning, policy stability, and temporal coordination as indispensable to diachronic agency. AASC preserves that diachronic architecture. A plan can specify a constraint bundle; a policy can serve as a continuing carrier; resource commitment can authenticate uptake; and a prior valid undertaking can govern routine execution without requiring a fresh metaphysical act of will at every step. This is especially important for omissions, professional duties, long-term projects, promises, and institutional authorization.

Planning nevertheless does not itself supply the entire free-will role. Plans can be proposed but not adopted, forged, coerced, internally inconsistent, outside the planner's authority, or generated by a process lacking standing. A plan can also be retrospectively reconstructed after outcome, violating no-repair discipline. The missing question is when a partial plan becomes the standing bearer's responsibility-bearing commitment rather than merely a representation of possible conduct.

AASC answers through adoption and fixation. A plan becomes commitment-bearing when a standing bearer accesses and takes up the determinate bundle through an adequate carrier under the domain's rules. Thereafter the plan can coordinate execution across time. Revision is possible through a new commitment event, but revision does not erase the historical identity of the prior token.

This relation clarifies both complementarity and difference. Bratman explains how intentions and plans make temporally extended agency possible. AASC explains when such planning acquires responsibility-authorship status. Planning supplies architecture; admissible commitment supplies binding.

Lemma FW-L08 - Planning-to-Commitment. Planning can define, stabilize, and coordinate a constraint bundle across time, but a plan becomes responsibility-binding only when a standing bearer validly adopts it through an adequate carrier within the fixed domain. A plan alone supplies neither standing nor admissibility.

In authored-uptake terms, planning can organize directed uptake across time and can provide a carrier, but the plan becomes authored only when the independent standing, access, carrier, admissibility, and non-displacement conditions hold.

The same result handles implicit commitment. A settled, previously adopted policy can govern later action without an explicit contemporaneous declaration. What matters is not continuous self-narration but a traceable fixation history linking the standing bearer to the operative bundle.

2.8 Strawson, Wallace, and the reactive-attitude tradition

Strawson's "Freedom and Resentment" redirects attention from abstract metaphysical conditions to the participant stance embodied in resentment, gratitude, hurt, forgiveness, demand, and excuse (Strawson 1962). Wallace develops a related account of responsibility in terms of moral sentiments and expectations (Wallace 1994). Their contribution is not merely sociological. They show that responsibility is lived through interpersonal address and that exemptions or excuses alter the appropriateness of participant responses.

Charitable concession. Strawson and Wallace correctly identify the interpersonal significance of responsibility practices, participant address, excuse, and forgiveness. AASC preserves this interpersonal insight. Reactive attitudes can be evidence that a community recognizes a commitment carrier, that an undertaking generated legitimate expectations, or that a bearer is treated as answerable. Excuse practices can also reveal where access, uptake, compulsion, or standing exercise failed. A responsibility system with no interpersonal or institutional uptake would often lack the public traceability needed for many carriers.

AASC nevertheless rejects the claim that response alone creates the prior authorship object. Communities can resent a scapegoat, forgive a genuine author, blame under fraud, deny standing unjustly, or enforce a role fiction that never matched the actual bearer-bundle relation. The participant stance can therefore track, contest, or misidentify authorship. It is not infallible constitution by reaction.

The distinction is temporal and critical. Commitment fixation precedes the later resentment, gratitude, demand, excuse, or forgiveness directed at it. Social practices can supply the rules by which carriers are recognized, but a particular reactive response cannot retroactively manufacture uptake or bundle identity. This permits criticism of institutions and communities rather than making their attitudes self-validating.

The objective attitude also receives a clearer place. Treatment, protection, management, or therapeutic response can be justified on grounds other than desert, even where responsibility-authorship is absent or contested. Conversely, recognizing authorship need not entail punitive

resentment. AASC therefore allows the Strawsonian practical insight while separating attribution from the downstream ethics of response.

Lemma FW-L09 - Reactive-Attitudes Downstream. Reactive attitudes and responsibility practices may register, contest, excuse, forgive, or misidentify responsibility-authorship, and practice rules may help define carrier uptake. A particular later response cannot create the prior bearer-bundle relation by reaction alone.

In authored-uptake terms, reactive attitudes can respond to, evidence, or contest an indexed authorship relation; they cannot constitute that relation merely by being directed at someone.

This is not an externalist retreat from practice. It is a non-circular account of how practices can be both indispensable and fallible.

2.9 Moral responsibility and the scope of the paper

"Moral responsibility" can refer to attributability, answerability, accountability, blameworthiness, liability, or desert (Scanlon 1998; Shoemaker 2015). The present paper focuses on **responsibility-authorship**: the relation in virtue of which a bearer is properly identified as author of a commitment bundle. This relation is necessary for many stronger responses but is not sufficient for all of them.

A person may author a harmful bundle and yet have a powerful excuse. A person may author a trivial bundle without meriting blame. A person may be answerable but not punishable. An institution may bear repair obligations even when retributive desert is inapplicable. By keeping these layers distinct, AASC avoids deriving moral conclusions from a structural predicate and preserves the sequencing question: first identify authorship; then ask what response, if any, is justified.

Part II - AASC Primitives for the Free-Will Problem

3. The AASC Setting

3.1 Fixed governance domain

Let **D** be a fixed governance domain. A domain is not merely a physical region or set of possible worlds. It is the structured field in which standing, admissibility, commitment carriers, and responsibility claims have determinate application. Examples include a legal order, an institutional authorization system, a contractual practice, or the canonical AASC responsibility domain.

The fixed-domain requirement blocks a common form of repair. A candidate that fails in one domain cannot be rescued by silently changing the governing rules, the bearer class, or the meaning of commitment. Cross-domain comparison is permissible, but the conclusion must be re-indexed. The same sound, gesture, or document can carry different commitments in different domains because the carrier rules differ. It cannot count as one valid commitment by borrowing standing from another domain without an admissible bridge.

We use the following notation:

D = the governed domain

A_D = candidate bearers in D

E_D = the constraint envelope fixed at the commitment event

$Stand_D(a) \in \{0,1\}$

$Adm_D(B) \in \{0,1\}$

The binary values are interface classifications. Evidence about them can be uncertain, incomplete, or probabilistic. The classification itself is not a probability.

3.2 Standing

3.2.1 Premise status of standing

Standing is a canonical AASC primitive in this paper, not a conclusion smuggled in under another name. The manuscript does not derive standing from consciousness, rationality, biology, intelligence, legal personality, social recognition, or moral worth. Those features may be evidence or domain-specific recognition conditions, but the extension of standing is a separate classification problem.

The central result is therefore explicitly conditional: **given** a bearer with standing in *D*, together with admissibility, fixation, and no post-selection repair, the relevant free-will role is admissible commitment capacity rather than outcome selection. A critic may reject standing, propose a different standing theory, or argue that no actual entity satisfies it. Those are direct challenges to a premise. They do not show that standing is identical to free will or that outcome control is required.

Lemma FW-L02 - Standing Premise-Status. Standing is assumed as the AASC eligibility predicate for the author role. Its presence does not itself establish free will, commitment, or responsibility for any bundle; its extension in particular domains requires independent classification.

Standing is the non-delegable property that licenses an entity to occupy the author role and bear responsibility. It is not a synonym for consciousness, intelligence, legal personality, causal influence, social status, or technical competence. Those properties may be relevant evidence in particular domains, but none can simply be substituted for standing.

The canonical AASC constraints treat standing as binary, global within the governed scope, conserved, and non-delegable. “Global” here means that standing is not fragmented into a different metaphysical amount for every decision. It does not imply that every institution recognizes every bearer or that every bearer can validly enter every transaction. “Conserved” means that execution, representation, or self-modification does not manufacture additional standing. “Non-delegable” means that a bearer may authorize another to act, but cannot transfer the authorship property as if it were a task.

Standing must be distinguished from **exercise conditions**. A sleeping person may retain standing while performing no commitment. A child or impaired adult may retain standing while lacking access to a particular bundle or an adequate carrier for a high-complexity transaction. An unauthorized employee may have standing as a person but lack institutional authority to bind the corporation. These are not fractions of free will. They are categorical failures in different components of the commitment construction.

Definition FW-D01 — Standing. A candidate bearer *a* has standing in domain *D* when *a* is licensed to occupy the responsibility-author role in *D*. Standing is binary at the AASC interface, conserved under execution and delegation, and not itself a causal power.

Object	AASC role	Not identical with
Standing	Eligibility to occupy the author role	Free will, consciousness, intelligence, legal status
Free will	Capacity of a standing bearer to author admissible commitments	Causation, outcome control, responsibility itself
Commitment	Historically fixed exercise event	Desire, intention, bodily motion, outcome
Responsibility-authorship	Relation attaching bearer to bundle	Blame, punishment, harm, social reaction

Object	AASC role	Not identical with
Execution	Downstream implementation of a bundle or policy	Standing, authorship, commitment fixation

The table makes the conditional architecture visible. Standing is necessary for AASC free-will capacity, but a standing bearer may make no commitment, may lack access to a bundle, or may attempt an inadmissible undertaking. Conversely, a sophisticated executor may perform complex actions without receiving standing by performance alone.

3.3 Admissibility

Admissibility is the gate that determines whether a candidate bundle can enter a responsibility-bearing construction. It enforces at least four conditions: standing integrity, scope integrity, internal coherence, and fixation discipline. A candidate can fail because the bearer lacks standing, because the bundle belongs to another domain, because the bundle is inconsistent or indeterminate, or because its identity is supplied only after the outcome is known.

Admissibility must not be moralized. A plan to commit a crime may be an admissible object of responsibility attribution even though it is legally prohibited and morally wrong. Indeed, if “admissible” meant “permitted,” wrongful commitment could never be attributed. The term is procedural and structural: the bundle is sufficiently coherent and properly carried to bind an author.

Admissibility is also not a confidence score. Investigators may be 70 percent confident that a signature is authentic, but the commitment token is either admitted or not admitted under the governing standard. Evidence can be graded; the interface decision is bivalent.

Definition FW-D02 — Admissibility. A candidate bundle *B* is admissible in *D* when it satisfies the standing, scope, coherence, and fixation conditions required to serve as the object of a valid commitment in *D*. Admissibility is structurally distinct from moral or legal permission.

Misreading	AASC correction
Admissible means morally good	No. It means structurally licensed to enter the responsibility-authorship construction.
Admissible means lawful	No. Law is one possible domain, and an unlawful plan may still be an attributable bundle.
Admissible means socially approved	No. Approval and recognition can be mistaken or unjust.
Admissible means causally possible	No. Causal possibility does not supply standing, uptake, or fixation.
Admissible means chosen	No. Ordinary choice-language is reconstructed as bundle formation, comparison, or binding.
Admissible means successful	No. Success and failure are downstream outcomes.
Admissible means excused	No. Excuse and mitigation are separate classifications.

Lemma FW-L03 - Admissibility Non-Moralization. Structural admissibility neither approves nor excuses a bundle. It determines only whether the candidate is sufficiently licensed, coherent, scoped, and fixed to serve as an object of responsibility-authorship.

The distinction is essential. If admissibility meant moral permission, wrongful commitments could never be attributed. If it meant causal possibility, accidents and reflexes would become commitments. If it meant social approval, institutional error would define authorship. AASC instead treats admissibility as a structural gate whose normative evaluation occurs later.

3.4 Constraint envelope

The constraint envelope **E_D** is the space of commitment targets recognized by the domain at the relevant time. The envelope includes substantive possibilities and the rules by which they are individuated. It may be created historically through legislation, institution-building, convention, or prior commitment, but it is fixed relative to the token now being evaluated.

The envelope is not a menu of outcomes from which consciousness selects actuality. It is not a probability distribution, a quantum state, or a metaphysical generator. It sets the boundary within which a commitment can be specified. An employment policy, for example, may permit several authorization bundles. The manager's commitment binds to one policy bundle; it does not cause the legal order to exist or select every downstream response.

Pre-existence is therefore relational: **E_D precedes C in the order of authorization**, even when both are temporally close. A bearer cannot validate a commitment by inventing its governing standard after seeing whether the outcome was favorable.

Definition FW-D03 — Constraint envelope. The constraint envelope E_D is the domain-fixed space of admissible commitment targets and individuation rules available prior to, and independently of the retrospective desirability of, a particular commitment token.

3.5 Irreversibility and fixation

A commitment event creates a historical relation. Once validly fixed, it cannot be converted into a non-event by later redescription. This is the relevant irreversibility. It does not mean that commitments are eternally binding or that correction is forbidden. A later act may revoke, amend, discharge, renounce, or supersede the first. The history then contains both acts.

This temporal discipline is familiar in ordinary governance. A contract can be rescinded, but the rescission presupposes that a contract existed. An order can be countermanded, but the countermand is not proof that the order was never issued. A promise can be released, but release does not

eliminate the promise token. A criminal attempt can be abandoned, but abandonment does not necessarily erase the earlier commitment state.

The no-post-selection rule protects that record. Later outcomes may reveal hidden defects that were present at fixation—fraud, incapacity, forgery, coercion, scope error. Discovery of a prior defect is not post-selection repair. The distinction is between **evidence about what the original token was** and **retrospective alteration because of what later happened**.

Definition FW-D04 — Historical irreversibility. A valid commitment token, once fixed, remains part of the governance history. Subsequent acts can alter its continuing force but cannot make the original valid token never to have occurred.

3.6 Bivalence at the interface, gradation in the evidence

AASC standing and admissibility are bivalent at the canonical interface. A candidate bearer either occupies the author role in the domain or does not. A candidate bundle either enters the valid commitment construction or does not. A particular token either fixes responsibility-authorship or fails to do so. The interface is not a continuum on which a bearer possesses 63 percent standing or a token is 42 percent committed.

This bivalence does not imply epistemic certainty or psychological simplicity. Three layers must be distinguished:

1. **Structural status.** The governed relation is standing/no standing, admissible/inadmissible, valid/invalid, attached/not attached.
2. **Evidence.** Testimony, clinical findings, records, behavior, and probabilities can support the status with different strengths.
3. **Institutional decision rules.** A court, board, clinician, or other body can use burdens, presumptions, thresholds, and standards of proof to decide how uncertain evidence affects action.

Gradation therefore belongs to evidence, confidence, exercise conditions, severity, response, and institutional policy. It does not become a primitive metric of free will. Two people can differ greatly in intelligence, self-control, knowledge, or susceptibility while both satisfy the same structural author relation for a simple bundle. The same person can satisfy it for one bundle and fail it for another because access or carrier conditions differ. Domain-indexed categorical variation is not a scalar quantity of metaphysical freedom.

The distinction blocks two errors. One is **metric inflation**, in which every psychological difference becomes a degree of free will. The other is **bivalent dogmatism**, in which a binary status is mistaken for certainty about the facts. AASC rejects both.

3.7 No post-selection repair

No post-selection repair is the prohibition against using downstream information to rewrite the object that was fixed upstream. It has three applications.

First, **outcome repair** is barred. A successful outcome does not make an incoherent commitment coherent; a failed outcome does not make a valid commitment unauthored.

Second, **scope repair** is barred. A bearer cannot invoke a different domain's rules only after the first domain yields an adverse result.

Third, **identity repair** is barred. The content of the bundle cannot be narrowed, expanded, or substituted after the fact merely to match what occurred.

The rule does not exclude learning. If later evidence demonstrates that the signature was forged, the original classification is corrected because the purported commitment never satisfied carrier adequacy. If later evidence merely shows that the bargain was unprofitable, no authorship defect follows.

4. Formal Objects, Commitment Carriers, and Validity Conditions

4.1 Bearer, bundle, carrier, and event

A rigorous account requires more than an agent and an outcome. It requires at least five objects:

1. a candidate standing bearer **a**;
2. a determinate bundle **B**;
3. a commitment carrier **k**;
4. a fixation event or interval **t**; and
5. a governed domain **D**.

The objects are jointly necessary because each answers a different question. Standing answers who can author. The bundle answers what is authored. The carrier answers how uptake becomes manifest and attributable. Fixation answers when the relation becomes historically stable. The domain answers which rules individuate bearer, bundle, carrier, and effect.

4.2 Constraint bundle

A constraint bundle is a determinate, internally coherent subset or rule-defined region of the envelope capable of fixing a responsibility object. "Subset" is not restricted to an extensional list. A policy, conditional plan, standing instruction, discretion-conferring rule, or risk authorization can determine a class of conduct without enumerating every member.

A valid bundle satisfies identity, coherence, scope, availability, and non-retrospection. Its identity can be stated; its constitutive requirements do not defeat one another; it belongs to the invoked domain; it lies within the fixed envelope; and its content is not supplied only after outcome.

Definition FW-D05 - Constraint bundle. A constraint bundle *B* is a determinate, internally coherent commitment target contained in *E_D*, individuated independently of later outcome and sufficiently specified to trace responsibility-authorship.

4.3 Commitment carriers: how capacity becomes an attributable event

A capacity does not attach responsibility until it is exercised through a carrier. A **commitment carrier** is the act, token, expression, omission under duty, authenticated instruction, vote, undertaking, or domain-recognized process through which a bearer manifests uptake of a bundle. Carriers can be linguistic, bodily, documentary, digital, institutional, or procedural. Their form depends on the domain.

Definition FW-D10 - Commitment carrier. A commitment carrier *k* is a domain-recognized token or process that manifests and authenticates a standing bearer's uptake of a determinate bundle at fixation.

Lemma FW-L04 - Commitment Carrier Generality. Commitment is not identical to legal signature, explicit speech, private intention, or bodily motion. Any of these may function as a carrier only when it validly links a standing bearer, a determinate admissible bundle, and a fixation condition in the relevant domain.

The generality of the carrier concept keeps the account from becoming legalistic. Contract is one carrier family, not the paradigm to which every commitment must conform.

Carrier family	Illustrative commitment	What the carrier fixes	What is insufficient by itself
Personal resolution	A bearer undertakes a future discipline	Self-binding policy bundle	Passing preference or wish
Friendship promise	One person undertakes support or confidentiality	Interpersonal expectation and answerability	Friendly sentiment alone
Apology	Acknowledgment plus undertaking of repair or non-repetition	Responsibility-facing corrective bundle	Words without uptake or authenticity

Carrier family	Illustrative commitment	What the carrier fixes	What is insufficient by itself
Artistic undertaking	Commitment to complete a work under stated standards	Project and practice bundle	Mere aspiration
Moral refusal	Binding non-participation in specified conduct	Prohibitory bundle	Momentary aversion
Solemn or religious vow	Domain-recognized long-term undertaking	Vow-defined obligation bundle	Theological truth of the tradition
Deliberate performance	Conduct accepted as uptake under practice rules	Action-defined bundle	Reflex, accident, or misunderstood action
Institutional authorization	Vote, order, or authenticated instruction	Office- or institution-indexed policy	Unauthorized employee conduct

A promise to oneself illustrates the role of domain indexing. Some domains recognize self-binding through resolutions, advance directives, recovery plans, or personal policies; others reserve enforceable commitment for interpersonal or institutional uptake. AASC does not decide that recognition by intuition. It asks whether the domain supplies an adequate carrier and fixation rule.

Carrier theory is indispensable because no one observable form is sufficient. A signature can be forged. A spoken "yes" can be coerced, misunderstood, or outside the speaker's authority. A private intention can be psychologically real while failing to constitute a contract. A bodily movement can be reflexive. A corporate vote can be procedurally void. A digital command can be issued under stolen credentials. In each case, the physical form exists while the bearer-bundle relation does not.

Conversely, no one physical form is necessary across domains. A commitment can be carried by explicit promise, deliberate performance, omission under an accepted duty, a sequence of institutional acts, or adoption of a standing policy. The carrier's function, not its surface, is canonical.

A carrier need not be public, externally witnessed, or legally enforceable. It must be **fixable**: the indexed domain must contain a non-retrospective rule by which bearer, bundle, carrier token, and fixation event can be identified. A private directive, recorded resolution, settled self-binding policy, or internally adopted plan can carry commitment where the domain recognizes that form. A fleeting intention, unrecorded wish, or post hoc self-description does not become a commitment merely by later interpretation. Publicity is one evidentiary route; fixability is the constitutive requirement. Private fixation is possible; private fluctuation is not commitment.

Lemma FW-L20 - Private Carrier Fixability. A commitment carrier may be private or public. Public manifestation is not constitutive; fixable bearer-bundle uptake under the indexed domain is. A private token carries commitment only when its identity, content, and fixation can be established without post-selection repair.

Lemma FW-L22 - Omission Carrier. An omission is not responsibility-bearing merely because something did not occur. It becomes commitment-relevant only when indexed to a prior or standing bundle, duty, role, policy, refusal, or undertaking whose carrier rules make non-performance attributable to the standing bearer.

4.4 Carrier validity and the uptake relation

A carrier is adequate only when it links the bearer and bundle under the domain's authentication and manifestation rules. Four questions must be answered:

- **Attribution:** does the token originate from or validly represent the purported bearer?
- **Content:** does it carry the identity-relevant bundle rather than an undisclosed substitute?
- **Uptake:** does it manifest adoption, authorization, endorsement, or undertaking in the required mode?
- **Effectivity:** has the domain-defined fixation condition occurred?

These questions distinguish intention, choice-language, and commitment. A desire is a motivational state. An intention is a plan-like state. A decision is a psychological or procedural transition. A commitment is the bearer-bundle binding that becomes responsibility-bearing under the governed carrier rules. Desires, intentions, and decisions can supply evidence or constitute part of a carrier, but none is automatically identical to commitment.

The same distinction applies to ordinary talk of choice. What ordinary language calls a choice is, at the AASC attachment layer, either bundle formation, bundle comparison, or bundle binding. Only the binding event fixes responsibility-authorship. The bearer does not thereby select which downstream future becomes actual.

4.5 Action, intention, choice, commitment, and execution

The AASC answer depends on refusing a second role collapse: not every action is a commitment, not every intention is will, and not every choice fixes responsibility-authorship. Ordinary language often slides among wanting, preferring, deciding, choosing, intending, undertaking, acting, and causing. The following distinctions control the manuscript.

Object	AASC role	Why it is not yet commitment
Desire	Motivational orientation toward an object or outcome	It does not by itself identify a bundle, carrier, or authorship relation.
Preference	Comparative inclination among options	It can shift without fixing an attributed object.
Intention	Prospective practical orientation or plan component	It can remain private, revisable, uncarried, or outside the relevant domain.
Choice	Ordinary-language surface category for selection or decision	It can name preference, deliberation, option narrowing, directed uptake, or fixation; AASC requires disambiguation.

Object	AASC role	Why it is not yet commitment
Mere action	Bodily, behavioral, computational, or institutional event	It may be reflexive, unauthorized, accidental, or pure execution.
Intentional action	Conduct performed under an agent-accessible description	The description may not identify a determinate responsibility bundle or fixation event.
Directed uptake	Bearer-directed adoption, authorization, undertaking, or refusal with respect to a bundle	It records direction toward a bundle without yet assuming standing, authorship, freedom, or fixation.
Authored uptake	Directed uptake that satisfies indexed authorship conditions	It is authored but not yet the historically fixing event.
Commitment	Historically irreversible fixation of valid authored uptake	This is the responsibility-authorship event.
Execution	Downstream implementation of a commitment, policy, or process	Performance may be delegated or automated and can diverge from the committed bundle.

An intention can contribute to directed uptake and can become commitment-bearing when it functions through an adequate self-binding or public carrier under the domain's rules. A promise can fix commitment before performance. A settled policy can continue to bind while later actions execute it. A bodily movement can occur without will or commitment, and commitment can exist even when execution fails.

The category of choice is therefore not banned; it is decomposed. When ordinary discourse says that an agent chose, AASC asks whether the token was a preference, deliberative selection, intention, directed uptake, authored uptake, or fixation of a responsibility-bearing bundle. Only fixation occupies the commitment role.

Lemma FW-L12 - Action-Intention-Commitment Distinction. Desire, preference, mere action, intentional action, intention, ordinary choice, directed uptake, authored uptake, commitment, and execution are non-identical. Responsibility-authorship requires a valid bearer-bundle-carrier relation and fixation. No mental state, bodily movement, or causal performance is sufficient by category alone.

Lemma FW-L14 - Commitment-Bearing Action. An action is commitment-bearing only when it fixes a standing bearer to a determinate admissible bundle through a valid bearer-bundle-carrier relation. Some commitment-bearing actions are explicit, such as promise or consent; others are implicit, such as undertaking a risk, adopting a policy, initiating a plan, or refusing participation. Mere movement, desire, intention, or causal production is insufficient.

These lemmas prevent commitment from becoming a renamed action. They also prevent private psychology from being ignored: desire, intention, endorsement, planning, and reasons-responsiveness can supply evidence about access and directed uptake. Their evidentiary importance does not erase the carrier, authorship, and fixation requirements.

4.6 Free, will, and free will

4.6.1 Directed uptake, indexed authorship, and authored uptake

The analysis begins with a token that can be identified without assuming the conclusion. A bearer can express, enact, or authorize orientation toward a bundle even when the token is later found to be coerced, forged, incompetent, inadmissible, or displaced. Calling that token **directed uptake** records its bundle-directed form; it does not yet classify it as authored, free, or committed.

Definition FW-D14 - Directed uptake. Directed uptake is a bearer-directed adoption, authorization, undertaking, or refusal with respect to a determinate bundle, described without presupposing standing, authorship, freedom, carrier adequacy, admissibility, non-displacement, or fixation.

Definition FW-D15 - Indexed authorship occupancy. Indexed authorship occupancy is the relational status obtained when a directed-uptake token has an eligible standing bearer, identity-relevant access to the bundle, an adequate carrier, an admissible bundle, and no displacing author under the rules of the indexed domain. It is an authorship classification, not a causal force or psychological feeling.

The conditions are independently contestable. Directed uptake can be identified before authorship is decided. Standing does not entail uptake. Access does not entail adoption. A carrier can be forged. A coherent bundle can be imposed. Non-displacement cannot be inferred from first-person language. Authorship is the conjunction of these conditions, not an unanalyzed intuition that the act was “really the agent’s.”

Lemma FW-L17 - Authorship Conditions. A directed-uptake token is authored only when (i) a standing bearer is identified, (ii) the bearer has identity-relevant access to the bundle, (iii) the token records adoption or authorization in the mode recognized by the domain, (iv) an adequate carrier manifests and authenticates that token, (v) the bundle is admissible, and (vi) no displacing source substitutes another authorship relation. Fixation is the subsequent or coincident event that converts valid authored uptake into commitment. Psychological identification, first-person endorsement, legal attribution, reasons-responsiveness, causal origination, and institutional labeling may supply evidence or realizers; none constitutes authorship by category alone.

Definition FW-D11 - Authored uptake. Authored uptake is a directed-uptake token that satisfies the conditions for indexed authorship occupancy. It is bearer-indexed, bundle-directed, carrier-mediated, admissibility-bound, non-displaced, and capable of fixation. It is not itself the fixation event.

Definition FW-D13 - AASC relational ownership. A bundle is the bearer’s own in the AASC sense when that bearer, rather than a displacing source, validly occupies the indexed author position for the relevant uptake token. At fixation, that relation becomes responsibility-authorship. Ownership here is relational and attributive, not psychological, proprietary, causal-originative, or metaphysical.

Lemma FW-L13 - Authored Uptake. A standing bearer wills in the AASC sense only when directed uptake of a determinate admissible bundle satisfies the independently specified conditions for indexed authorship occupancy. Desire alone does not bind; intention alone may remain uncarried; causation alone may occur without an author; outcome alone is downstream. Authored uptake is therefore the admissible remaining role for will.

4.6.2 AASC-free uptake: the positive AASC content of freedom

Definition FW-D12 - AASC-free uptake. Authored uptake is AASC-free when the standing bearer validly and non-displacedly occupies the indexed authorship relation under the domain's standing, access, carrier, admissibility, anti-laundering, and no-post-selection conditions.

This is not a scalar freedom metric. Evidence can be partial, clinical, probabilistic, or contested. Institutional burdens can be graduated. The structural interface remains bivalent for an indexed token: the authorship conditions are satisfied or they are not. The positive content of AASC freedom is valid authorship occupancy, not a causal power over outcomes. The defect predicates identify circumstances in which that positive relation is absent, corrupted, or displaced.

Lemma FW-L18 - Positive Freedom as Valid Occupancy. AASC freedom consists positively in the standing bearer's valid, non-displaced occupancy of the indexed authorship relation. Its defect conditions are boundary tests for that occupancy, not substitutes for a scalar power over outcomes.

4.6.3 Free will

Definition FW-D06 - Free will. Free will is the standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the conditions for admissible indexed authorship and become fixed as commitment; equivalently, the capacity for admissible authored uptake.

The capacity is standing-bound because an entity without standing cannot occupy the author role and because standing cannot be transferred to a mere executor. It is a capacity rather than an event because a standing bearer can possess it while making no current commitment. It is non-causal as an authorship predicate because it adds no force to the empirical account of the carrier.

4.6.4 Why this is still free will

Lemma FW-L16 - Why This Is Still Free Will. The term is retained because the structure supplies the capacity condition historically invoked when free will is used to ground responsibility, excuse, consent, commitment, blame, liability, or accountability. AASC rejects metaphysical excess while preserving the admissible authorship role without which those uses cannot do responsibility-bearing work.

AASC does not preserve every inherited meaning of free will. It preserves the role that connects a standing bearer to an authored commitment object while explaining why causation, alternatives, outcomes, and social reaction cannot alone perform that work. “The bearer’s own” denotes valid indexed authorship, not subjective enthusiasm, higher-order endorsement, phenomenological ownership, legal title, or ultimate self-origination.

4.6.5 Why the additional roles are not ad hoc

The vocabulary is introduced only where ordinary free-will discourse already performs distinguishable jobs. Standing identifies author eligibility; capacity identifies what a bearer can do; directed uptake identifies the bundle-directed token without assuming authorship; indexed authorship occupancy states the independent relation test; authored uptake records success under that test; the carrier identifies manifestation and authentication; fixation identifies historical attachment; responsibility-authorship identifies the resulting relation; causation identifies implementation; and response identifies what persons or institutions later do about it. Collapsing any pair recreates a familiar failure: eligibility becomes exercise, intention becomes commitment, self-description becomes authorship, causation becomes responsibility, outcome becomes attachment, or reaction becomes retrospective creation.

Lemma FW-L19 - Role Decomposition Necessity. The AASC role vocabulary is not an ornamental multiplication of entities. Each role corresponds to a distinct function already demanded by responsibility-bearing free-will discourse, and no simpler same-scope account is adequate if it performs those functions only by reintroducing the collapsed roles covertly.

4.7 Commitment

Definition FW-D07 - Commitment. Commitment is the historically irreversible responsibility-fixing act by which valid authored uptake is fixed: a standing bearer, through an adequate carrier, becomes bound to a determinate admissible constraint bundle within the envelope fixed for the event.

“Binds itself” identifies later answerability, not emotional intensity or metaphysical self-creation. A commitment may be explicit or implicit, episodic or policy-like, personal or institutional. It need not be a solemn promise. A deliberate act can carry commitment when the domain treats the act as fixation of the bearer’s authored uptake.

Commitment has causal realizers without becoming a causal competitor. Neural processes, reasons, social influences, and bodily motions can explain how directed uptake and the carrier arose. The commitment definition explains why that carrier counts as the bearer’s responsibility-bearing fixation event.

The semantic sequence is strict:

will = directed uptake satisfying the authorship conditions; free = valid, non-displaced authorship occupancy; free will = the standing-bound capacity for such uptake; commitment = irreversible fixation; responsibility-authorship = the relation fixed thereby.

4.8 Responsibility-authorship

Definition FW-D08 - Responsibility-authorship. Responsibility-authorship is the authorship relation that attaches a standing bearer to the bundle it validly commits to at fixation.

We represent the relation as:

$$\text{Resp_D}(a, B, t) = 1$$

only if the constitutive conditions hold. Responsibility-authorship is indexed to **B**, not to a later outcome **o**. Outcomes can affect harm, damages, sanction, repair, and evidence. They do not constitute the earlier author relation.

4.9 Downstream causation

Definition FW-D09 - Downstream causation. Downstream causation is the physical, psychological, social, computational, or institutional evolution through which a commitment carrier is implemented, frustrated, transformed, or followed by outcomes.

“Downstream” is relative to fixation for the attribution question. It does not deny upstream causes of commitment or effects of the carrier. It prevents causal realization from being mistaken for the author relation.

4.10 Six relational validity conditions and fixation

Let $U = \langle a, B, k, D \rangle$ be a directed-uptake token and let t be a candidate fixation event or interval. Indexed authorship occupancy requires six conditions:

V1 - Standing. a has standing in D .

V2 - Access. a has sufficient access to the identity-relevant content of B to take up that bundle rather than an unknown substitute.

V3 - Directed uptake. U records a 's adoption, authorization, undertaking, or refusal with respect to B in the mode recognized by D , without presupposing that the token is authored or free.

V4 - Carrier adequacy. k reliably manifests and authenticates U under the rules of D .

V5 - Bundle admissibility. B lies within E_D , is internally coherent, and is individuated without retrospective outcome repair.

V6 - Non-displacement. No other author or mechanism substitutes a different authorship relation while using a merely as an execution channel.

The indexed authorship relation is therefore derived rather than assumed:

$$AU_D(U) = V1 \wedge V2 \wedge V3 \wedge V4 \wedge V5 \wedge V6.$$

Commitment adds fixation:

$$\text{ValidCommit_D}(C) \leftrightarrow AU_D(U) \wedge F(U, t).$$

These conditions and fixation are categorical. Evidence for them can vary in strength, and institutions can use burdens of proof. The governed object remains bivalent.

4.10.1 Validity conditions and evidentiary handles

AASC supplies the constitutive conditions. Particular domains supply evidence used to determine whether they are satisfied.

Constitutive condition	Typical evidentiary handles
Standing	Role eligibility, competence, authority, domain-recognized bearer status
Access	Notice, understanding, disclosure, intelligibility, ability to identify the bundle
Directed uptake	Assent, adoption, authorization, undertaking, refusal, repeated conduct, resource allocation, policy adoption
Carrier adequacy	Signature, promise, speech act, performance, authorization, witnessed undertaking, authenticated record
Bundle identity/admissibility	Stable description, material terms, non-concealment, scope clarity, internal coherence
Non-displacement	Absence of coercive control, bypass, direct control, implanted uptake, carrier substitution, authorship replacement
Fixation	Domain-recognized completion, authenticated adoption, effective vote, undertaking, launch act, or settled self-binding event

These are evidentiary handles, not new primitives and not mechanically sufficient tests. Assent can be coerced, repeated conduct can be compulsive, a signature can be forged, and institutional recognition can be erroneous or unjust. Evidence of directed uptake is not authored uptake; evidence of a carrier is not carrier adequacy; evidence of standing is not standing itself. AASC supplies the defect grammar; factual adjudication determines whether the indexed relation is present.

Lemma FW-L21 - Evidence/Constitution Distinction. Evidentiary indicators help determine whether an AASC constitutive condition is satisfied; they are not themselves constitutive by category. No signature, assent, endorsement, repeated conduct, diagnosis, or institutional label is automatically identical to standing, directed uptake, indexed authorship occupancy, carrier adequacy, or commitment.

4.11 Five principal defect routes

Hard cases are organized by five principal routes, with uptake tracked explicitly inside them:

1. **Standing defect:** the purported author cannot occupy the relevant author role.
2. **Access defect:** the bearer cannot identify or understand enough of the attributed bundle.
3. **Bundle-identity defect:** the object is incoherent, unavailable, misdescribed, or retrospectively supplied.
4. **Carrier/uptake defect:** the token does not authentically or adequately manifest the bearer's adoption.
5. **Authorship displacement:** another source substitutes its commitment while the apparent bearer functions as conduit.

The classification avoids the statement that an agent was merely "less free." It identifies which constitutive component failed.

4.12 Minimal formal model

Let **S(a)** mean standing; **A(a,B)** identity-relevant access; **U_D(a,B,k)** directed uptake; **K(k,a,B)** carrier adequacy; **M(B,E_D)** envelope membership; **I(B)** internal coherence; **N(a,B,k)** non-displacement; and **F(U,t)** fixation independent of later outcome. Define indexed authorship occupancy as:

$$O_D(a,B,k) \leftrightarrow S(a) \wedge A(a,B) \wedge K(k,a,B) \wedge M(B,E_D) \wedge I(B) \wedge N(a,B,k).$$

Authored uptake is directed uptake under that independently specified occupancy relation:

$$AU_D(a,B,k) \leftrightarrow U_D(a,B,k) \wedge O_D(a,B,k).$$

Commitment adds fixation:

$$C_D(a,B,k,t) \leftrightarrow AU_D(a,B,k) \wedge F(U,t).$$

And:

$$C_D(a,B,k,t) \rightarrow \text{Resp_D}(a,B,t).$$

The implication is conservative: valid commitment entails responsibility-authorship attachment. The converse holds only where the indexed domain reserves **Resp** for responsibility-authorship fixed by valid commitment. Broader strict, vicarious, status-based, or remedial attributions can be modeled only by adding their own non-authorship premises. No outcome variable appears in the antecedent. Outcome variables enter only in downstream causal, remedial, evidentiary, or evaluative doctrine.

4.13 From declared primitives to derived answer

Definitions FW-D00 through FW-D15 specify the AASC model. Some are declared primitives or domain parameters; others are derived relational definitions. Directed uptake is specified without assuming authorship. Indexed authorship occupancy is a conjunction of independently contestable conditions. Authored uptake is then derived from directed uptake plus that occupancy relation; commitment adds fixation; responsibility-authorship attaches to the fixed bundle. Their adequacy is tested through consistency, explanatory power, hard-case classification, and resistance to same-scope counterexamples. Keeping stipulation distinct from derivation prevents proof by vocabulary alone.

Part III - The Core Theorem Chain

5. Standing, Free Will, and Role Separation

5.1 The anti-circularity challenge

The most serious internal objection is that the theory might conceal the very agency it claims to explain. That would occur if standing meant “whatever has free will,” if uptake were called authored merely because it came from the apparent bearer, or if “own” meant an unanalyzed intuition of psychological identification. AASC blocks those moves by sequencing the predicates.

Standing is eligibility for an author role, not proof that any token is authored. Directed uptake records a bearer-directed relation to a bundle without classifying that relation as free or authored. Access, carrier adequacy, bundle admissibility, and non-displacement are independently contestable. Indexed authorship occupancy is the conjunction of those conditions. Authored uptake is the directed token under that occupancy relation. Commitment is the fixation event. Responsibility-authorship is the resulting bearer-bundle relation.

The distinctions yield different extension and timing conditions. A bearer can have standing while asleep and make no commitment. A bearer can direct uptake toward an inadmissible bundle. A non-standing machine can execute a complex policy. A signature can be authentic yet coerced; a first-person statement can be forged; a coherent bundle can be imposed. These witness cases prevent the predicates from collapsing.

Lemma FW-T17 - Standing/Free-Will Non-Identity. Standing is necessary for the AASC free-will capacity but is not identical to it. Standing marks eligibility for the author role; free will is the capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the authorship conditions; commitment is the exercise and fixation event; responsibility-authorship is the relation fixed by valid exercise.

5.2 Proof of non-identity

Assume standing and free will are identical. Then every standing bearer would, by standing alone, instantiate the full free-will object. But standing can persist without any current access, uptake, carrier, or commitment. No bundle is then attributed. Therefore standing is not sufficient for exercise or attachment.

Assume commitment and free will are identical. Then free will exists only during event tokens and disappears between commitments, contradicting its status as a capacity. Assume execution and free will are identical. Then a non-standing executor would acquire authorship by performing a task,

violating standing conservation. Assume responsibility-authorship and standing are identical. Then every standing bearer would be responsible for every bundle available to it, which is absurd. The roles are therefore non-identical. Standing is necessary but not sufficient; valid exercise requires V1-V6. ■

5.3 What standing contributes - and what it does not

Standing contributes author-role eligibility. It does not supply bundle content, understanding, uptake, carrier authenticity, or freedom from displacement. The theory therefore does not solve every question of agency merely by uttering "standing." It declares one primitive and exposes the independent conditions that must join it.

This is analogous to other formal domains. Legal capacity does not itself create a contract; ownership does not itself create a transfer; membership does not itself create a vote. The status licenses a kind of act whose validity still depends on object, procedure, and event. The analogy is structural, not a claim that standing reduces to law.

The extension of standing remains a substantive open problem. AASC cannot infer it from intelligence, consciousness, complexity, or causal influence alone. That limitation is explicit and later becomes a possible refutation route: if standing cannot be coherently grounded or individuated, the AASC answer fails at P2 rather than being rescued by hidden redefinition.

5.4 The problem of illicit role identity

The free-will debate becomes unstable when objects occupying different logical roles are treated as identical. A capacity can explain eligibility to perform an act, but it is not the act. Commitment can fix responsibility, but it is not the entire causal process implementing the bundle. Outcome can supply evidence about execution, but it cannot constitute the earlier author relation without violating fixation.

If free will is the commitment event, a standing bearer has no free will except at instants of exercise. If commitment is outcome production, failed attempts become unauthored and lucky successes become more attributable. If responsibility is causal contribution, storms, software faults, and reflexes become candidate authors merely because they made a difference.

Theorem FW-T01 - Role Separation. Within a fixed AASC domain, standing, free will, commitment, responsibility-authorship, and downstream causation occupy distinct roles. Identifying any two as the same object either collapses status into capacity, capacity into event, authorship into causal production, or responsibility into outcome.

5.5 Proof

Standing/free-will identity fails by FW-T17. Free-will/commitment identity collapses capacity into event. Free-will/causation identity either duplicates empirical causes or adds an unlicensed selector. Commitment/causation identity makes responsibility depend on successful implementation and cannot classify failed attempts. Responsibility/outcome identity permits post-selection repair. Standing/execution identity manufactures authorship by delegation. Each proposed identity violates at least one declared role or constraint. Therefore the roles must remain distinct. ■

5.6 Role and realizer

The theorem distinguishes a governance role from its empirical realizer. A commitment event is realized by causal processes and can itself produce effects. Non-causality means only that the free-will predicate adds no independent physical force.

Corollary FW-C01 - Realization Compatibility. A commitment carrier may be fully causally realized and causally efficacious while free will, commitment-authorship, and responsibility remain non-causal authorship roles.

5.7 Upstream causation is not excluded

Reasons, character, upbringing, neural states, laws, incentives, and other agents can contribute to a commitment event. Their presence does not automatically displace authorship. The relevant question is whether they defeat a validity condition. This distinction is the basis of determinism invariance and the later treatment of manipulation.

6. Constraint-Internal Freedom and Bundle Binding

6.1 Why absence of constraint cannot ground freedom

A common picture treats freedom as the residue left when constraints are removed. AASC reverses that picture. Without a domain, there is no standing rule. Without an envelope, there is no admissibility boundary. Without a bundle, there is no determinate object. Without a carrier rule, there is no identifiable fixation event. An unconstrained "will" therefore cannot fix responsibility because nothing determines who is bound, to what, or when.

Constraint must not be confused with coercion. Constraint is the constitutive structure that makes a commitment intelligible. Coercion is a possible defect within that structure. Grammar constrains an intelligible promise; contract rules constrain an agreement; a practical policy constrains future

conduct; an institutional charter constrains authority. Removing every such condition does not create maximal freedom. It removes the object to which responsibility could attach.

Positive AASC freedom is non-defective authored uptake within this structure. The uptake is free when access, authored adoption, carrier adequacy, bundle admissibility, fixation, and non-displacement hold. Constraint supplies the field of intelligibility; the validity conditions distinguish free uptake from defective uptake.

Theorem FW-T18 - Constraint-Internal Freedom. At the AASC layer, free will is possible only within a constraint envelope. Freedom is not absence of constraint but valid, non-displaced, non-laundered, non-post-selected authored uptake within constraint. Without a determinate admissible bundle there is no will object; without adequate uptake and carrier there is no free exercise; without commitment there is no responsibility fixation.

6.2 Proof

Responsibility-authorship requires a bearer, admissible object, carrier, and fixation rule. Each is domain- and constraint-dependent. If all constraints are absent, no candidate can be classified as standing, no bundle can be individuated, no carrier can be authenticated, and no fixation event can be recognized. Therefore unconstrained willing cannot occupy target R. AASC free will is necessarily constraint-internal. ■

6.3 Envelope-wide binding fixes nothing

The constraint envelope contains the admissible target space fixed for the event. A valid commitment cannot bind to the envelope without a rule that restricts responsibility to a determinate bundle. "I commit to whatever the envelope contains" leaves every incompatible admissible path open and identifies no responsibility object.

Theorem FW-T02 - Bundle Target. A valid commitment binds a standing bearer to a determinate admissible constraint bundle, not to the undifferentiated constraint envelope.

6.4 Proof

Commitment must fix an object of answerability. The undifferentiated envelope contains all admissible candidates and therefore excludes none. An apparent envelope-wide commitment either fixes no object or contains an implicit rule that selects a subset or policy. In the latter case the rule-defined subset is the actual bundle. Therefore commitment targets a bundle. ■

6.5 Bundle binding is not outcome selection

The theorem preserves a limited and exact sense of agency. A bearer can compare candidate bundles and bind itself to one rather than another when the domain permits. That operation selects the object of responsibility, not the realized state of the world. The preferred expression is **bundle binding**, because ordinary "choice" language often equivocates between selecting an undertaking and selecting actuality.

A commitment to attempt a rescue binds the bearer to a course of conduct even if rescue fails. A commitment to follow a risk policy binds the institution even if no loss occurs. A promise binds the promisor while performance remains contingent on later causes. These examples would be unintelligible if bundle binding were outcome selection.

6.6 Conditional, policy, and risk bundles

A determinate bundle need not specify one immediate movement. A conditional bundle can state what is to be done if a condition occurs. A policy bundle can authorize later executors within a scope. A risk bundle can authorize conduct under known ranges of uncertainty. Determinacy lies in the rule, scope, and uptake, not exhaustive prediction.

Such bundles make the account suitable for temporally extended agency while preserving fixation. Later contingencies can activate clauses already contained in the bundle. They cannot retroactively insert clauses solely because an outcome occurred.

7. Internal Coherence and Defective Bundles

7.1 Coherence as a constitutive condition

A bearer cannot bind itself to a contradiction as a single determinate commitment. It may express inconsistent desires or issue incompatible instructions, but the resulting object either decomposes into multiple commitments, contains a priority rule, or fails as a coherent bundle. Responsibility cannot attach to “both perform X and never perform X in the same respect and conditions” unless the domain specifies which clause governs.

Theorem FW-T03 — Internal Coherence. A valid commitment target must be internally coherent relative to the governing domain, scope, and fixation conditions. An incoherent target is not an admissible constraint bundle and cannot ground responsibility-authorship as a single commitment object.

7.2 Proof

By FW-D05, a bundle must be sufficiently determinate to support traceability. If constitutive requirements are jointly unsatisfiable without a priority or exception rule, no single object of performance or answerability is fixed. Because no post-selection repair permits the later outcome to decide which clause “really” governed, the incoherent target cannot be admitted as one bundle. It may be decomposed or rejected, but it cannot bind as stated. ■

7.3 Six recurrent defective bundle forms

Contradictory bundle

The bundle contains incompatible requirements with no ordering rule. Example: an instruction requires disclosure and absolute nondisclosure of the same item to the same recipient at the same time. The defect is not that performance is difficult; the object is underdetermined by contradiction.

Scope-shifting bundle

The purported commitment invokes standing or authorization from one domain to bind another without an admissible bridge. A corporate officer’s personal promise does not automatically bind the corporation. A legal permission does not automatically establish moral justification. A moral conviction does not automatically create legal authority.

Post-selected bundle

The bundle’s content is supplied after the outcome. “I committed to whatever result would prove best” is not a determinate antecedent policy unless “best” and the decision rule were fixed. Otherwise the statement launders hindsight into authorship.

Laundered bundle

An inadmissible component is hidden under an admissible label. Calling surveillance “quality assurance” does not determine whether the bundle satisfies the relevant authorization conditions. Labels cannot repair content.

Delegated-standing bundle

The bundle treats execution authority as if it transferred the author role. “The contractor decided, so the principal has no responsibility” fails when the principal authored the governing bundle and merely delegated implementation. Conversely, an executor cannot bind the principal beyond the authorized bundle merely by acting.

Envelope-wide bundle

The purported object is the entire space of possible conduct with no restrictive rule. It fails FW-T02.

7.4 Conflict, revision, and multiple commitments

Real agents often hold conflicting commitments. AASC does not infer that no responsibility exists whenever conflict occurs. Instead, it asks whether the domain recognizes multiple bundles, a priority rule, a superseding act, or a failure of determinacy. A later commitment can revise an earlier one prospectively. The history then records an ordered sequence:

$$C_1(a, B_1, t_1), C_2(a, B_2, t_2), t_2 > t_1.$$

If B_2 validly supersedes B_1 , the continuing force changes at t_2 . Historical authorship of B_1 remains. This is the formal reason revocation is compatible with irreversibility.

7.5 Incomplete bundles

Not every omitted detail makes a bundle invalid. Domains use default rules, interpretive conventions, and reasonable ranges. The structural question is whether the missing content is identity-relevant. A purchase order can be valid despite unspecified delivery minutiae if the governing framework supplies defaults. A blank authorization to “do whatever you think” may be valid as a discretion-conferring policy bundle if scope and fiduciary constraints are fixed. Determinacy is functional, not maximal.

8. Responsibility Attachment and Outcome Independence

8.1 The attachment point

Responsibility must attach somewhere. Before a bearer commits, there is no determinate authored object. At the outcome, attachment is too late: attempts, plans, permissions, and authorizations would disappear whenever execution failed, and luck would rewrite the actor’s relation. The commitment event is the first point at which a standing bearer, a bundle, and an adequate carrier are jointly fixed.

Theorem FW-T04 — Responsibility Attachment. When a standing bearer validly commits to a determinate admissible constraint bundle, responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation and is indexed to that bearer–bundle relation.

8.2 Proof

A responsibility-authorship relation requires (i) an eligible author and (ii) an identifiable authored object. Standing supplies the author role; the valid commitment supplies the object and binding act. Before fixation, no complete relation exists. After fixation, all constitutive conditions are present. Since outcome is neither part of FW-D07 nor required by V1–V6, waiting for outcome adds no constitutive element and would violate no post-selection repair. Responsibility-authorship therefore attaches at fixation. ■

Corollary FW-C02 — Outcome Independence. Whether responsibility-authorship attaches is not a function of which downstream outcome occurs. It is a function of whether the bearer validly committed to the bundle.

8.3 Outcome relevance after attachment

Outcome independence at the authorship layer does not erase consequence. Outcomes can determine:

- whether harm occurred;
- the magnitude and distribution of loss;
- whether completion or attempt doctrines apply;
- compensatory obligations;
- remedial urgency;
- proportionality of institutional response;
- what evidence becomes available;
- whether a continuing commitment should be revoked or revised.

These are downstream functions. A legal system may punish completed harm more severely than an attempt. A moral theory may treat negligence differently when harm occurs. A compensation regime may be outcome-triggered. None of those rules shows that the earlier commitment lacked an author.

8.4 Moral luck at the authorship layer

Suppose two drivers knowingly commit to the same reckless driving bundle. One encounters no pedestrian; the other causes death. The outcomes support different legal and remedial responses, but the risk bundle is authored in both cases. AASC therefore neutralizes outcome luck only at the authorship layer. It does not claim that every legitimate response must be equal.

This layered result is stronger than simply saying “intentions matter.” The commitment bundle can include accepted risks, safeguards, omissions, and conditional policies. The theory attributes the structured object, not a private mental wish. It can therefore recognize responsibility for reckless or negligent risk authorization without pretending the bearer chose the precise harm.

8.5 Attempts and impossible attempts

Because responsibility attaches at commitment, failed execution does not erase authorship. An attempted action can be responsibility-bearing when the bearer binds to the relevant bundle and launches an adequate carrier. An “impossible attempt” can also be authored if the bundle is determinate relative to the bearer’s understanding, even when external facts prevent realization. Whether law should punish it is a separate doctrine.

The case exposes the weakness of outcome identity. If no prohibited result occurs, an outcome-based theory must either deny authorship or invent a hypothetical outcome. AASC needs neither move.

8.6 Good outcomes from defective commitments

A fortunate consequence cannot repair a defective bundle. A reckless experiment that accidentally benefits a patient does not become valid consent. A forged authorization that produces profit does not become the principal’s commitment. A coerced confession that happens to be true is not made voluntary by accuracy. These results follow directly from no post-selection repair.

9. Randomness and the No-Outcome-Selection Result

9.1 Randomness does not supply authorship

Indeterminism is often introduced as the alternative to determinism. But causal openness does not by itself create an author. A random transition can alter which event occurs without identifying a standing bearer, an admissible bundle, uptake, a carrier, or fixation. Randomness can affect execution; it cannot substitute for commitment.

Lemma FW-T19 - Randomness Non-Authorship. Indeterminacy, stochastic transition, or branching does not by itself generate free will or responsibility-authorship, because randomness neither has standing nor binds itself to a constraint bundle.

Proof

Responsibility-authorship requires V1-V6. Randomness describes the causal relation among possible events and supplies none of V1-V4 or V6. Adding randomness to a process therefore cannot transform an unauthored event into a commitment. If a standing bearer validly commits within an indeterministic process, authorship derives from the commitment relation, not from the indeterminacy. ■

9.2 No outcome selection

Theorem FW-T05 - No Outcome Selection. Free will, as standing-bound capacity, neither selects outcomes nor determines which admissible possibility becomes actual. Commitment binds a bearer to a responsibility object; downstream causal processes realize, frustrate, or transform outcomes.

Free will is a capacity predicate and contains no outcome variable. Commitment binds a bearer to **B**, while outcome **o** depends on causal evolution, other agents, environmental conditions, and possibly branching structures. If free will selected **o**, it would duplicate the causal account or add an unlicensed selector. If commitment selected **o**, failed attempts, risk authorizations, and stochastic execution would be conceptually impossible. Therefore neither free will nor commitment selects actuality. ■

9.3 No branch collapse

In a branching description, commitment need not collapse a branch. It can specify a policy that applies across successors. Responsibility remains indexed to the pre-branch bundle; branch-specific agents can later make additional commitments.

9.4 No probabilistic or informational re-anchoring

Probability can represent evidence, risk, or expected consequence. Information processing can support access and deliberation. Neither is free will. A probability distribution does not have standing, and an information update does not by itself create uptake. Recasting free will as probability assignment or information selection merely moves the illicit selector into a new vocabulary.

9.5 No envelope enlargement by willing

A bearer cannot make an unavailable bundle admissible through intensity of desire. It can seek to change the envelope through a separate authorized commitment - legislation, amendment,

negotiation, or institutional creation - but the current commitment is assessed under the envelope fixed for it.

10. The AASC Same-Scope Free-Will Exhaustion Theorem

10.1 Target and premises

Target **R** is the governance role that identifies author eligibility, the authored object, the fixation point, historical persistence, and separation from downstream realization. The theorem assumes:

- **P1:** a fixed domain is required for determinate governance claims;
- **P2:** standing is the non-delegable author-role predicate;
- **P3:** admissibility is bivalent at the structural interface;
- **P4:** valid targets are determinate bundles within an envelope fixed for the event;
- **P5:** commitment is historically irreversible;
- **P6:** no post-selection repair is allowed;
- **P7:** responsibility-authorship requires an identifiable bearer, object, carrier, and fixation event;
- **P8:** no additional causal, probabilistic, informational, or modal selector may be introduced without independent license.

A candidate occupies R only if it supplies all five functions. Supplying a theory of causation without an author, a phenomenology without a public object, or a norm of blame without fixation is insufficient.

Theorem FW-T06 - Conditional Same-Scope Exhaustion of the AASC Free-Will Role. Given P1-P8, the only same-scope object capable of occupying R is the standing-bound capacity to author admissible commitments, exercised through a valid commitment event. Any proposed same-scope alternative either omits a function of R, collapses distinct roles, relocates responsibility to outcome, imports an unlicensed selector, or changes the domain.

10.2 Adequacy of admissible commitment

Admissible commitment supplies every function of R. Standing supplies author eligibility. The constraint bundle supplies object identity. The carrier and fixation event supply the binding point. Historical irreversibility and no post-selection repair preserve attachment. Role separation distinguishes authorship from execution and response. The construction is therefore adequate before competitors are considered.

10.3 Exhaustion by candidate class

Candidate A: uncaused or agent causation

An uncaused causal power may purport to explain outcome origination, but it does not by itself specify standing, bundle identity, carrier, or fixation. If it is added solely to distinguish authored causes, it is an unlicensed selector under P8. If "agent cause" means only that an action is attributable to a standing bearer through commitment, it redescribes the AASC relation without adding a rival object.

Candidate B: alternative possibility

A set of alternatives describes the envelope or a model of futures. It does not identify which bearer bound itself to which bundle. Alternatives can exist without commitment, and commitment can occur when alternatives are blocked. Alternative possibility cannot occupy R.

Candidate C: outcome control

Outcome control is neither necessary nor sufficient for responsibility-authorship. Attempts can be authored without success, while non-standing systems can control outputs. It also relocates fixation after execution and violates P6.

Candidate D: conscious phenomenology

A felt experience of deciding can evidence access and uptake, but it neither specifies a public bundle nor authenticates a carrier. Experiences can be mistaken, manipulated, or institutionally unauthorized.

Candidate E: indeterminism or randomness

Indeterminism describes causal openness. By FW-T19, a random transition has no standing and binds itself to nothing. It cannot supply R.

Candidate F: reasons-responsiveness

Reasons-responsiveness can support access and uptake, but a responsive mechanism can lack standing, target an inadmissible bundle, or execute another author's policy. It is evidence or an exercise condition, not the complete relation.

Candidate G: hierarchical endorsement

Higher-order endorsement can instantiate uptake, but it cannot by itself supply standing, scope, bundle coherence, carrier adequacy, or fixation.

Candidate H: planning agency

Planning can organize bundles across time, but a plan can be copied, imposed, generated, or executed without valid authorship. It becomes responsibility-bearing through commitment.

Candidate I: institutional convention

Convention can specify carriers and recognition rules, but it cannot replace canonical standing merely by declaration. It contributes to domain form, not the complete author relation.

Candidate J: causal sourcehood

If sourcehood means ultimate self-creation, it is outside R and impossible for finite bearers. If it means proper authorship of the commitment, it is equivalent to the relation already identified.

10.4 Exhaustion conclusion

Every candidate supplies only a component, changes R into a different problem, or becomes equivalent to admissible commitment after inflationary content is removed. The AASC object therefore exhausts the stated role under P1-P8. This is not a semantic victory. It is a functional result: the proposed object must perform author, object, fixation, persistence, and separation functions in the hard cases.

10.5 What the theorem does not exhaust

The theorem leaves open the phenomenology and neuroscience of agency, the metaphysics of laws, naturalistic accounts of standing, theories of moral desert, the design of excuse doctrines, the normative content of envelopes, and the standing of nonhuman entities. It exhausts only the responsibility-authorship role. This limitation is a condition of rigor.

10.6 Burden after the theorem

A same-scope rival must identify an object that performs every function of R without using the AASC relation and without violating P1-P8. Naming "control," "choice," "sourcehood," or "consciousness" is not enough. The rival must state bearer, object, carrier, fixation, persistence, and hard-case behavior. Section 31 gives the exact counterexample forms.

Part IV - Determinism, Branching, and Alternative Possibility

11. Determinism Invariance

11.1 Determinism as a causal thesis

Determinism, roughly stated, holds that a complete state of the world together with the laws fixes later states (van Inwagen 1983; Lewis 1981). The challenge is often expressed as a loss of alternatives or control: if the past and laws fix the commitment, the bearer could not have produced a different outcome. AASC does not answer by inserting indeterminacy. It asks whether determination destroys a constitutive condition of commitment.

Theorem FW-T07 - Determinism Invariance. Determinism defeats the AASC free-will object only if an additional argument shows that determination entails failure of standing, access, uptake, carrier adequacy, bundle admissibility, fixation, or non-displacement. Mere causal determination does not erase a valid commitment or relocate responsibility-authorship.

11.2 The causal-determination objection

The first objection is direct: if prior conditions caused the commitment, the bearer did not author it. This inference equivocates between causing and authoring. Upstream conditions can explain why a carrier occurred while the carrier still manifests the standing bearer's uptake. To defeat authorship, the causal history must do more than produce the event; it must bypass, corrupt, or replace a validity component.

A teacher can cause a student to consider a reason without becoming author of the student's undertaking. A law can cause an officer to act while the officer remains author of a discretionary abuse. A lesion can cause behavior by defeating access or carrier control. The first two cases preserve authorship; the third may not. Causation alone does not classify them.

11.3 The consequence-argument challenge

The consequence argument maintains that, if determinism is true, present acts are consequences of the remote past and laws, neither of which is up to the agent. AASC grants the fixity claim for the sake of argument. It denies that R requires power over the remote past or laws. Target R requires valid authorship of a bundle at fixation, not power to render total history false.

This is not a rebuttal to every conception of "up to us." It is a scope diagnosis. If "up to us" means ability to make the past or laws otherwise, the requirement belongs to an alternative-possibility or ultimate-source theory. If it means the bearer-bundle relation is not displaced and is adequately carried, it is already represented by V1-V6. The consequence argument threatens the former, not the latter, unless a bridge premise is supplied from fixity to a specific V-condition failure.

11.4 Proof of non-entailment

Assume a deterministic world in which $C_D(a,B,k,t)$ satisfies V1-V6. Determinism states that the event and consequences are fixed by prior state and laws. It does not entail not-S(a), not-A(a,B), not-U(a,B), not-K(k,a,B), not-Adm(B), or not-N(a,B). To derive invalidity, an additional premise must connect determination to one of those negations. No such premise follows from determinism alone. Therefore valid commitment and responsibility-authorship remain. ■

11.5 Determined does not mean displaced

Authorship displacement is specific. It occurs when another source substitutes its bundle, controls the carrier in a way that bypasses directed uptake, corrupts identity-relevant access, or uses the apparent bearer as an instrument. Deterministic causal production is universal under the hypothesis; displacement is not. Treating them as identical would erase the distinction between ordinary influence, education, persuasion, threat, compulsion, implantation, and direct control.

Authorship is not origination ex nihilo. It is valid, indexed occupation of the bearer-bundle-carrier relation. A causal explanation can identify why the bearer formed an intention, directed uptake toward a bundle, adopted a policy, or produced a carrier without showing that some other author occupied that relation. The explanatory question and the attribution question are distinct.

Lemma FW-L15 - Causal Explanation Non-Displacement. A causal explanation of directed uptake, authored uptake, or commitment does not defeat authorship unless it entails a validity-condition failure: standing failure, identity-relevant access failure, carrier corruption, bundle inadmissibility or misidentification, displacement, coercive bypass, fraud, incapacity, or authorship replacement. Explaining why a bearer occupies the authorship relation is not the same as displacing the bearer from it.

This lemma does not prove that every causally explained token is valid. It identifies the additional burden. The skeptic must show how the causal history defeats one or more constitutive conditions, not merely that a causal history exists.

11.6 The ultimate-source objection

A critic may require the bearer to have chosen its character, motives, susceptibility to reasons, and every condition of commitment. This is an upstream totalization: authorship of one bundle requires authorship of the complete author. No finite bearer can satisfy it. The demand does not identify a defect in the token; it replaces R with metaphysical self-creation.

Corollary FW-C03 - No Ultimate-Source Requirement. Responsibility-authorship does not require that a bearer author its existence, character, laws, or complete causal history. It requires valid authorship of the indexed commitment bundle.

11.7 The manipulation argument

Manipulation arguments press the continuity between an obviously engineered agent and an ordinarily determined agent (Pereboom 2001, 2014; Mele 2019). AASC accepts the pressure to identify a non-question-begging difference. Its answer is not "natural causation good, artificial causation bad." The difference lies in the commitment relation.

Direct implantation can bypass access and uptake, impose bundle content, control the carrier, or displace the apparent bearer. Ordinary formation need not do so. Persuasion can alter reasons while leaving the bearer in control of uptake. Socialization can shape character without substituting a token-level author. Some histories will fall between these cases, and evidence may be difficult, but the classification burden is exact: show which component was bypassed or displaced.

The argument from manipulation to universal determinist non-responsibility therefore needs a bridge: every deterministic formation history must be equivalent, with respect to V1-V6, to authorship substitution. That bridge is not supplied by determinism itself. If it can be established, AASC yields skeptical results; if not, the analogy does not erase valid commitments.

11.8 Determinism and excuse

Determinism invariance does not abolish excuses. Insanity, coercion, mistake, incapacity, and manipulation can defeat V2-V6 in deterministic and indeterministic worlds alike. The theory rejects the false binary between universal excuse and no excuse. Excuse is component-specific.

11.9 Compatibilist-looking, structurally distinct

The result resembles compatibilism because responsibility can survive determination. The route is different. AASC does not reconcile a favored kind of causal control with determinism. It shows that

outcome-control was not the responsibility attachment role. The invariant object is admissible commitment-authorship.

12. Branching Invariance

12.1 Forms of branching

“Branching” can describe several structures:

- epistemic branching, where the agent is uncertain which outcome will occur;
- modal branching, where a model represents several possible futures;
- causal branching, where one policy can yield several paths under contingent inputs;
- physical branching, as in some interpretations of quantum mechanics;
- institutional branching, where delegates or procedures implement a bundle through different routes.

The AASC result does not depend on which structure is metaphysically correct. It depends on the bundle being fixed before the relevant outcome path is known.

Theorem FW-T08 — Branching Invariance. In a branching regime, valid responsibility-authorship remains indexed to the committed bundle and does not fragment into separate authorships merely because multiple downstream paths or outcomes exist.

12.2 Proof

Let **B** be fixed at **t** and let downstream evolution produce branches $\mathbf{o}_1 \dots \mathbf{o}_n$. The constitutive conditions for **Resp_D(a,B,t)** are satisfied before branch realization. Since no branch variable is part of the attachment relation, multiplication of outcomes does not multiply or relocate the original authorship. Branch-specific later commitments may create additional relations, but the initial relation remains bundle-indexed. ■

12.3 Responsibility for a branching policy

A bearer can commit to a policy that delegates responses to later contingencies. Responsibility then attaches to the policy bundle, including its branching rule. If a later executor makes an independent commitment outside the policy, a new authorship relation may arise. Structural analysis requires distinguishing policy authorship, execution authorship, and causal outcome.

This is particularly useful for institutions. A board can approve a risk policy, managers can implement it, and employees can make local decisions. The downstream tree does not force all

responsibility to one node. It permits layered commitments without confusing them with branches as physical outcomes.

12.4 No responsibility multiplication by worlds

A branching metaphysics might describe multiple successors. AASC does not infer that the original bearer made a different commitment in each branch. The token at fixation has one bundle identity. Successor-specific actions can generate new commitments, but they do not retroactively change the first.

12.5 Branching and regret

Regret often tracks the realized outcome. A bearer may wish it had committed differently after one branch becomes salient. Regret can motivate revocation, repair, or new policy. It cannot re-index the historical commitment. This is a direct application of no post-selection repair.

13. Frankfurt-Style Cases and Alternative Possibilities

13.1 The structural question

Frankfurt-style cases place a counterfactual intervener in the background (Frankfurt 1969). If the agent begins to choose otherwise, the intervener will ensure a target action; in the actual sequence, intervention is unnecessary because the agent acts as desired. The cases aim to show that responsibility may survive the absence of accessible alternatives. AASC accepts that possibility only when the actual commitment remains authored by the standing bearer.

AASC does not rely on intuitions about a single vignette. It classifies the intervention. There are two fundamentally different structures:

1. **alternative removal:** the intervener blocks other paths but does not author the actual commitment;
2. **authorship displacement:** the intervener supplies, substitutes, or controls the actual bundle or carrier.

Only the second directly defeats the AASC relation.

Theorem FW-T09 — Alternative-Possibility Non-Necessity. The availability of a distinct alternative outcome is not necessary for responsibility-authorship when a standing bearer validly authors the actual bundle and authorship is not displaced.

13.2 Proof

V1–V6 do not include a requirement that another outcome remain available. They require a standing bearer, bundle access, uptake, adequate carrier, admissibility, and non-displacement. If those conditions hold while an intervener blocks alternatives, the commitment remains valid. Therefore alternative possibility is not necessary for attachment. ■

Theorem FW-T10 — Intervention Displacement. When an intervener replaces the apparent bearer's uptake, determines the attributed bundle through unauthorized substitution, or uses the bearer merely as a carrier, responsibility-authorship for that bundle is displaced from the apparent bearer to the relevant authoring source, subject to that source's standing and commitment.

13.3 Mere surveillance

An intervener who watches but never acts does not displace authorship. Surveillance may be wrongful and may alter psychology, but it does not automatically change the commitment object. The relevant evidence concerns whether the bearer's uptake remains operative.

13.4 Counterfactual blocker: the inactive Frankfurt intervener

Fact pattern. A standing bearer deliberates and commits to bundle B. An intervener monitors the process and would force B if the bearer began to commit to not-B, but no intervention occurs in the actual sequence.

Will. The standing bearer authors the actual uptake of B. The blocker does not supply the actual bundle, adoption, or carrier.

Free. Uptake remains non-displaced in the actual sequence. The unavailable alternative narrows the counterfactual envelope but does not corrupt the bearer-bundle-carrier relation.

Commitment. An adequate carrier fixes the bearer's authored uptake of B. V1-V6 can remain satisfied.

Result. Responsibility-authorship attaches to the standing bearer for B despite the absence of alternative possibilities. The intervener may bear separate responsibility for surveillance, coercive preparation, or attempted control, but those wrongs do not displace the actual commitment merely by existing in reserve.

Reserved questions. The result does not determine blame, desert, or sanction. It also changes if monitoring corrupts uptake or if the intervener's prior actions engineered the actual bundle. The case establishes only that removal of alternatives is not identical to authorship replacement.

13.5 Actual intervention: authorship displacement

Fact pattern. The intervener detects deviation and implants the target intention, forces the commitment carrier, substitutes a document, or directly controls the apparent bearer's action so that B is realized.

Will. The apparent uptake is replaced, bypassed, or authored by another source. Intention-like content in the apparent bearer does not establish authored adoption.

Free. Non-displacement fails. Depending on the mechanism, access, uptake, carrier adequacy, or bundle identity may also fail.

Commitment. The actual token does not fix the apparent bearer's admissible authored uptake. The fact that the bearer would independently have done the same does not repair the intervened token.

Result. Responsibility-authorship for the intervened commitment is displaced, blocked, or re-indexed to the actual authoring source, subject to that source's standing and commitment. The apparent bearer may retain responsibility for an earlier independent policy or for later ratification, but neither retroactively authors the intervened token.

Reserved questions. Causal contribution, harm, negligence, and institutional liability can be distributed among multiple actors. AASC does not require one exclusive causal source; it requires accurate authorship localization for each commitment bundle.

13.6 Buffer and flicker strategies

Debates over whether a tiny “flicker of freedom” remains in Frankfurt cases concern residual alternatives. AASC does not need the flicker. A residual sign may be evidence that the bearer retained uptake or attempted resistance, but the attachment criterion is direct. The same framework can classify a case whether or not a metaphysically robust alternative survives.

13.7 Omission and preemption

An intervener can also preempt action or induce omission. The analysis remains the same: identify the bundle, carrier, and author source. If the bearer previously committed to a policy and the intervener merely blocks one execution path, responsibility for the policy can remain while responsibility for the blocked outcome does not arise. If the intervener authors the omission through coercive substitution, displacement may occur.

13.8 What Frankfurt cases establish here

Under AASC, Frankfurt cases do not prove that ordinary agents possess metaphysical freedom. They demonstrate that alternative availability and authorship can vary independently. That separation supports the bundle-indexed account while leaving the empirical facts of each case open.

Part V - Hard Cases: Defect, Coercion, Manipulation, and Incapacity

14. Standing, Exercise Conditions, and Incapacity

14.1 Structural classification versus factual adjudication

AASC supplies a **defect grammar**, not omniscience about contested facts. The theory can state what must be true for a commitment to be valid and what kind of defect would defeat it. It cannot determine from the armchair whether a signer was threatened, whether a patient understood a risk, whether credentials were stolen, whether an addiction bypassed uptake, or whether a board vote satisfied a charter. Those are evidentiary and empirical questions.

Once the facts are established, the structural classification is not open-ended. A hard case must locate success or failure in one or more components:

Defect route	Structural question	Typical evidence
Standing failure	Was there an eligible bearer in the relevant role?	Charter, status rule, standing determination
Access failure	Could the bearer identify the attributed bundle?	Disclosure, comprehension, memory, communication
Uptake failure	Did the bearer adopt or authorize the bundle?	Deliberation, endorsement, conduct, testimony
Carrier failure	Did the token authentically carry the commitment?	Signature, authentication, procedure, context
Bundle failure	Was the target determinate, coherent, scoped, and non-retrospective?	Terms, policy, record, timing
Displacement failure	Did another source replace or override authorship?	Coercion, forgery, manipulation, intervention
Evidence failure	Are the available facts insufficient to classify the structure?	Burden and standard of proof

Lemma FW-L05 - Structural/Factual Adjudication. AASC determines the consequence of a validity-condition success or failure; factual adjudication determines whether that condition is satisfied in the case. Evidentiary uncertainty does not create a third structural value between valid and invalid commitment.

This division of labor is a strength rather than evasion. A theory that purported to decide empirical facts by definition would be unreliable. AASC instead makes the factual burden explicit and prevents the word "coercion," "addiction," or "incapacity" from operating as an unanalyzed conclusion.

14.2 Why incapacity must not become graded standing

Hard cases are often described by saying that a person had “less free will.” That phrase obscures whether the problem lies in the bearer, the bundle, access, uptake, carrier, or displacement. AASC preserves bivalent standing while allowing exercise conditions to fail. This is crucial for persons whose capacities fluctuate. Sleep, intoxication, delirium, severe pain, panic, or cognitive impairment may prevent a valid commitment at one time without erasing the bearer’s standing.

The theory therefore rejects two errors. The first is **standing erosion**, where temporary functional difficulty is treated as partial loss of personhood. The second is **standing inflation**, where sophisticated performance is taken to create standing in an executor. Standing and exercise are related but non-identical.

Theorem FW-T11 — No Responsibility Without Valid Commitment. A standing bearer does not incur responsibility-authorship for a candidate bundle unless a valid commitment event satisfying V1–V6 occurs.

The theorem follows directly from FW-D08. Standing is necessary for authorship but not sufficient for any particular attribution.

14.3 Unconscious conduct

An unconscious movement, reflex, seizure, or sleepwalking episode ordinarily lacks uptake and carrier adequacy for a new commitment. The person may retain standing throughout, but no new bearer–bundle relation is fixed. Prior commitments can still matter. A driver who knowingly commits to driving while dangerously sleep-deprived may author a risk bundle before later unconscious conduct. Responsibility then attaches to the earlier commitment, not to a fictional decision during unconsciousness.

This distinction prevents both over-attribution and easy evasion. The involuntary movement is not authored merely because it occurs through the person’s body. Yet a prior policy or risk authorization can make the sequence attributable at a different temporal point.

14.4 Reflex and habit

Reflexes are causal responses without current uptake. Habits are more complex. A habit may execute a previously authored policy, may be a trained but currently non-deliberative routine, or may be a purely automatic response. Analysis should ask whether a prior commitment bundle governs the routine and whether the current context falls within it.

A practiced surgeon need not consciously recommit to every hand movement. The operative commitment can be policy-like and temporally extended. Conversely, an involuntary flinch is not made responsible by its regularity. The theory therefore avoids equating deliberative phenomenology with authorship while still requiring a valid commitment somewhere in the chain.

14.5 Children and developing agents

Developmental status should not be modeled as a fractional standing score. A child can be a standing bearer while lacking identity-relevant access to complex legal or institutional bundles. Domains may recognize limited carrier forms, protective defaults, or surrogate structures. Those doctrines concern exercise and recognition, not the child's metaphysical proportion of personhood.

The bundle-specific approach is more humane and more precise. A child may validly commit to a simple promise but not understand a complex financial guarantee. The difference is V2 and perhaps V4, not a scalar quantity of freedom. A legal age rule may be a bright-line evidentiary or protective rule even when underlying capacities vary continuously.

14.6 Cognitive impairment

Cognitive impairment can affect memory, comprehension, appreciation, communication, or consistency. These map to access, bundle identity, uptake, and carrier adequacy. A diagnosis alone does not decide the classification. The relevant question is whether the person could identify and take up this bundle through this carrier at this time.

The approach also blocks retrospective opportunism. A poor outcome does not itself prove incapacity. Evidence must bear on the conditions at fixation. Conversely, a favorable outcome does not validate a token formed without comprehension.

14.7 Intoxication and self-induced impairment

Intoxication may prevent a valid current commitment, but a prior commitment can include the decision to enter an impairment state under known risks. Responsibility can therefore be temporally layered:

- **C₁**: commitment to consume or proceed despite risk;
- **C₂**: purported action while impaired;
- **O**: downstream harm.

C₂ may be invalid while C₁ remains attributable. The framework does not dictate criminal doctrine; it clarifies the possible attachment points. A domain can then decide which prior risk bundles are legally or morally relevant.

14.8 Institutional incapacity

Organizations can also lack exercise conditions. A board may have standing to bind the institution under its charter, while an individual officer lacks authority for a particular transaction. The person retains personal standing; the institutional bundle fails scope or carrier rules. This illustrates why standing, authority, and competence cannot be merged.

15. Coercion and Duress

15.1 Constraint is universal; coercion is a defect structure

All commitment occurs under constraint. Agents face physical laws, limited information, social conditions, deadlines, costs, and dependencies. If freedom required absence of constraint, no commitment could be free. Coercion must therefore be distinguished from constraint by its effect on the validity relation, not by intensity alone.

A threat can produce several different structures. It can alter incentives while leaving the bearer's uptake intact; it can destroy access to any bundle the bearer can author in the relevant role; it can force the carrier; it can replace the bundle; or it can shift responsibility toward the coercer. The word "coercion" does not decide which occurred.

Theorem FW-T12 — Coercion Defect Classification. Coercion is responsibility-relevant when it produces a categorical defect in access, uptake, carrier adequacy, bundle identity, or non-displacement. Mere causal pressure or an unattractive option set does not by itself establish invalidity.

15.2 Threat versus substitution

Suppose a person signs a transfer under a threat. The signature may be authentic as a bodily act but inadequate as a carrier of voluntary uptake under the domain's rules. The bundle can be known, yet the coercer's standing commitment—"transfer or suffer harm"—may displace the victim's authorship of the transfer. Different domains can classify the same facts differently: contract law may void the transfer; criminal law may excuse conduct; moral assessment may allocate responsibility among actors.

AASC does not resolve those doctrines by definition. It supplies the variables. The more the coercer controls the bundle identity and carrier while the apparent bearer functions as a conduit, the stronger the displacement case. The more the bearer retains policy ownership under severe but ordinary pressure, the more likely authorship remains with mitigation rather than invalidity.

15.3 The gun-to-head signature: carrier authenticity under coercion

Fact pattern. A coercer threatens immediate serious harm unless a victim signs a transfer instrument. The victim understands the document and physically signs it.

Will. The victim may author a survival-oriented uptake - signing to avoid death - without adopting the transfer bundle as its own commitment object. Physical execution and textual comprehension are not sufficient.

Free. The non-displacement and carrier conditions may fail. The coercer's threat structures the token so that the signature is used as an instrument of the coercer's bundle rather than as valid uptake by the victim.

Commitment. The signature is an authentic bodily token but can be an inadequate commitment carrier for consent to transfer. V3, V4, or V6 can fail even when V2 comprehension is present.

The case contains more than one possible commitment. The coercer authors the threat and attempted transfer scheme. The victim may author a survival response. A legal domain may void the transfer; a moral domain may excuse the victim; a criminal domain may ask whether the victim authored any independently wrongful conduct. These downstream classifications can differ because their indexed bundles differ.

Result. The signature alone does not attach the transfer commitment to the victim. Where the token is the coercer's instrument rather than the victim's free authored uptake, responsibility-authorship for the transfer is invalid or displaced.

Reserved questions. Threat severity, credibility, resistance opportunities, prior complicity, and bundle scope are factual matters. AASC supplies the defect grammar; it does not decide contested facts by label.

15.4 Economic pressure

Economic pressure can be severe without automatically displacing authorship. The analysis asks whether the pressure is wrongful under the domain, whether it controls the carrier, whether genuine uptake remains, and whether the bundle was misdescribed. A bad bargain made under need can still be authored; a transaction produced by unlawful exploitation may be voidable. AASC resists converting these distinctions into a single numerical freedom threshold.

15.5 Necessity and emergency

Natural emergencies constrain options without another standing author. A person who breaks into a cabin to avoid freezing may author the action while possessing an excuse or justification. The

environment causes pressure but does not displace authorship. This is a decisive reason not to define coercion as “could not reasonably do otherwise.” Necessity can preserve authorship while altering normative evaluation.

15.6 Coerced wrongdoing

When a person harms another under threat, several layers must be separated:

- authorship of the bodily act;
- authorship of the harmful bundle;
- authorship of the threat;
- access to alternative protective bundles;
- excuse or mitigation;
- downstream causation and harm.

AASC does not guarantee that the threatened actor has no responsibility. It prevents the outcome alone from deciding. The domain must classify whether V3, V4, or V6 failed and what normative doctrine follows.

15.7 Coercion evidence and bivalence

Evidence of coercion can be probabilistic. Witness credibility, threat severity, and causal influence may be uncertain. The final interface classification can still be bivalent under a burden of proof. The theory’s opposition to graded free will is not opposition to graded evidence.

16. Manipulation, Addiction, Compulsion, and Formation

16.1 Manipulation as a sourcehood challenge

Manipulation cases intensify the deterministic worry (Pereboom 2001; Mele 2006). An agent’s values or decision process are engineered so that the agent appears to endorse a target action. If ordinary causal formation is compatible with responsibility, why should artificial formation differ? AASC answers by examining authorship displacement rather than causal abnormality alone.

A manipulator displaces authorship when it substitutes a target bundle, bypasses the bearer’s identity-relevant access, corrupts the carrier, or makes the apparent uptake merely instrumental to the manipulator’s commitment. Ordinary education and persuasion influence without necessarily displacing. The line is structural, not a contest between “natural” and “artificial” causes.

16.2 Direct implantation

If a device implants a specific intention and controls the carrier while the bearer lacks access to the substitution, V2, V3, and V6 may fail. The apparent action is not attributable merely because it is realized in the bearer's body. The manipulator's own responsibility depends on its standing and commitment.

A case can be less clear when implantation changes standing dispositions over time and the bearer later reflectively endorses them. AASC requires a new fixation analysis. Later uptake can author a new bundle; it cannot retroactively author the original manipulation. This temporal distinction avoids all-or-nothing judgments about transformed persons.

16.3 Persuasion and social formation

Arguments, education, culture, and relationships shape values. Causal influence alone is not displacement. The bearer can receive reasons, revise policies, and author the resulting bundle. To classify all influence as manipulation would eliminate social agency and make authorship impossible.

The relevant difference is whether the influence leaves the bearer in the author role. Transparency, opportunity for uptake, identity of the bundle, and carrier control are evidence. No single feature is an infallible metric, but each maps to a constitutive condition.

16.4 Addiction: token-specific validity rather than scalar freedom

Addiction can narrow practical access, intensify motivation, impair foresight, destabilize policy, and produce repeated conflict between settled commitments and episodic conduct. It does not generate a uniform authorship verdict. At least four structures must be separated:

1. the bearer validly authors uptake despite a powerful contrary desire;
2. access to competing policy bundles is impaired but identity-relevant uptake remains;
3. compulsion defeats authored uptake or carrier control for the episode;
4. a prior commitment to abstain remains historically authored while a later relapse is behavior that does not fix a new commitment to the whole relapse bundle.

Extended case. A bearer has previously adopted and publicly carried an abstinence policy, later encounters a trigger, and relapses. Inquiry must distinguish the standing abstinence commitment, any local uptake of a substance-seeking bundle, the compulsive phase, deception used to obtain it, and later repair undertakings. Different tokens can receive different classifications.

Will. The question is whether the bearer authored uptake of each indexed bundle. Desire, craving, and intentional movement do not by themselves establish a commitment to the entire relapse sequence.

Free. Freedom is not measured in units. Each token is tested for access, authored adoption, carrier adequacy, bundle identity, and non-displacement. A disorder process can defeat a condition without eliminating standing globally.

Commitment. A prior abstinence commitment can remain historically valid even when execution fails. A relapse can contain independently authored sub-bundles, such as deception or procurement, while other phases remain compulsive or non-commitment behavior.

Result. Addiction is neither automatic exculpation nor automatic attribution. Responsibility-authorship attaches only where the complete conditions hold. Mitigation, treatment, protection, and desert remain downstream.

The decisive question is not "How many units of freedom remained?" It is which bundle, if any, this standing bearer freely took up and fixed at this time through this carrier.

16.5 Compulsion

Compulsion differs from strong desire when the apparent bearer cannot take up or carry a contrary governing bundle in the relevant event. This can be a carrier defect, access defect, or displacement by a pathological mechanism. Calling the mechanism a "cause" is insufficient, because ordinary reasons are causes too. The classification depends on whether the mechanism leaves the bearer's uptake as the operative author relation.

16.6 Disorders of agency

Some psychiatric or neurological conditions produce alien-action reports, command hallucinations, dissociation, or loss of motor control. AASC offers a map, not a diagnosis. Clinical evidence can bear on bundle identity, access, uptake, and carrier adequacy. The theory should never be used to infer incapacity from a label alone.

16.7 Character formation and constitutive luck

No agent chooses its initial temperament, family, language, or early environment. This constitutive luck shapes later commitments (Nagel 1979; Williams 1981; Levy 2011). AASC denies that authorship requires ownership of every formative cause. A bearer can author a present bundle without having authored the conditions that made it attractive.

The skeptical challenge remains normatively important. Constitutive luck may undermine claims of ultimate desert or justify compassion and restraint. But it does not by itself negate the bearer–bundle relation. The account thus separates authorship from a maximal desert thesis.

16.8 Self-modification

A standing bearer may commit to training, therapy, education, medication, or technological modification. The later bearer does not gain additional standing merely through improvement. The earlier commitment can govern the modification bundle; later commitments are evaluated at their own fixation points. Self-improvement can enhance access or carrier reliability without manufacturing standing.

This is a direct application of standing conservation. It also prevents a paradox in which improving performance makes an entity “more of an author” in the canonical sense. Performance changes; standing does not become metric.

17. Ignorance, Mistake, Fraud, and Misdescription

17.1 Identity-relevant knowledge

Commitment does not require exhaustive knowledge of every consequence. It requires enough access to bind to the attributed bundle. The scope of required access is domain-dependent. A patient need not understand biochemistry to consent to a procedure, but must understand identity-relevant nature, risks, and alternatives under the governing standard. A buyer need not foresee every market fluctuation, but cannot be bound to a hidden term that changes the transaction’s identity.

Theorem FW-T13 — Ignorance and Bundle Identity. Ignorance defeats responsibility-authorship for an attributed bundle when it prevents the bearer from accessing or taking up identity-relevant content of that bundle. Ignorance of downstream detail that does not alter bundle identity need not defeat commitment.

17.2 Factual ignorance

Factual error can change the object. A person who takes another’s identical bag believing it is their own has not committed to a theft bundle in the ordinary sense, though negligence may be separately attributable. A person who knowingly takes the bag while uncertain about ownership may commit to a risk bundle. The difference lies in what was taken up, not in the eventual discovery.

17.3 Normative ignorance

Ignorance of law or morality is more difficult (Smith 1983). A bearer can author conduct without knowing that it is prohibited. The bundle identity may be intact while blame or liability doctrines treat ignorance differently. AASC therefore does not make normative knowledge a universal condition of authorship. It asks whether the domain defines the norm as identity-relevant to the commitment or as a downstream evaluative property.

17.4 Scope ignorance

A person may understand an act but misunderstand the role in which it operates. An employee signs personally while believing the corporation is bound; a patient thinks a form is informational rather than consent; a voter misunderstands whether a resolution is advisory or binding. These are scope and carrier problems. The physical token alone cannot settle them.

17.5 Fraud

Fraud can corrupt access by supplying false identity-relevant content. If the bearer signs for transaction B_1 while the fraudster attributes B_2 , the bearer has not committed to B_2 . The fraudster may have authored a deception bundle. A later profitable outcome cannot repair the mismatch.

17.6 Misdescription by the bearer

A bearer can also self-misdescribe. Calling a bribe a “facilitation fee” does not change the bundle if the underlying conduct is understood. Labels matter only when they affect access or scope. AASC therefore combines anti-laundering discipline with sensitivity to genuine mistake.

17.7 Foreseeability

Foreseeability is not identical to authorship but can define risk-bundle content. If a consequence was within the class the bearer knowingly authorized, responsibility can extend to the risk commitment even without outcome selection. If the consequence was radically outside the bundle, downstream liability may be limited. Different normative systems can set different foreseeability rules without moving the attachment point.

17.8 Later discovery

Later evidence can reveal what the original token was. This is not prohibited repair. The analysis distinction is:

- **epistemic correction:** new evidence shows that V1–V6 were or were not satisfied at fixation;

- **post-selection revision:** the classification is changed merely because the outcome is now known or preferred.

Only the second is barred.

18. Adjudicated Test Cases

18.1 Method of adjudication

The framework is not complete if it merely names possible defects and returns every difficult case to the domain. This section therefore applies one fixed sequence to concrete cases:

1. identify the purported standing bearer;
2. identify the bundle attributed to that bearer;
3. identify access and uptake;
4. identify the carrier and fixation point;
5. test admissibility and non-displacement;
6. state a determinate authorship verdict; and
7. separate downstream excuse, harm, sanction, or remedy.

The verdicts are structural. A legal order can add different doctrines, but it cannot reverse the bearer-bundle facts without changing the domain or introducing new evidence.

18.2 Case 1: ordinary promise

Facts. An adult says to a neighbor, "I will return your tool tomorrow," understands the request, intends the undertaking, and speaks in circumstances where promises are recognized.

Analysis. Standing is present. The bundle is determinate: return the identified tool by the stated time, subject to ordinary background conditions. Access and uptake are adequate. The utterance is an adequate carrier and no other author displaces it.

Verdict. A valid commitment attaches responsibility-authorship to the promisor. Nonperformance does not create authorship; it is a later failure relative to an already authored bundle. An unforeseeable impossibility can excuse or discharge performance without making the promise never to have occurred.

18.3 Case 2: authenticated contract signature

Facts. A competent authorized party reviews material terms and signs an agreement through a recognized procedure.

Analysis. The terms plus domain defaults form the bundle. Signature and authentication fix uptake. Standing and authority are distinct: the person may have personal standing yet also require institutional authority to bind a corporation. Here both are present.

Verdict. Responsibility-authorship attaches to the signing bearer or institution in the recognized capacity. Breach, damages, and enforceability are downstream. A favorable outcome does not strengthen authorship, and a costly outcome does not erase it.

18.4 Case 3: signature under a gun threat

Facts. A coercer threatens immediate death unless the bearer signs a transfer.

Analysis. The bearer has standing and may understand the bundle, so V1 and V2 can hold. The key questions are uptake, carrier adequacy, and displacement. In a domain where the threat destroys voluntary authorization, the signature no longer adequately carries the bearer's undertaking; it is a compelled execution token serving the coercer's bundle.

Verdict. The transfer commitment does not attach to the threatened signer at the ordinary authorship layer. Responsibility for producing the token shifts toward the coercer. This is not because the signer faced constraint; all commitment is constrained. It is because the threat corrupted the bearer-carrier relation. Separate responsibility for collateral conduct under duress can require a different bundle analysis.

18.5 Case 4: fraudulent consent

Facts. A patient consents to procedure B1 after being told it is B1, while the clinician secretly intends materially different procedure B2.

Analysis. The patient may have standing, genuine uptake, and an authentic signature. But access is to B1, not B2. The visible carrier cannot bind the patient to identity-relevant content that was concealed. The clinician's deception substitutes bundle content.

Verdict. The patient authors commitment to B1 if B1 is admissible; no patient commitment to B2 arises. The fraudster can be responsible for the substituted bundle. A successful medical outcome cannot cure the hidden-bundle defect.

18.6 Case 5: material mistake

Facts. A buyer signs for parcel 17 believing it contains the item inspected, but a clerical switch placed a materially different item inside. No one intended deception.

Analysis. The question is bundle identity. If parcel number alone defines the bundle under the domain, the buyer may have committed to parcel 17 despite factual mistake. If the inspected item's identity is constitutive, access and uptake concern a different bundle. The answer is fixed by pre-outcome rules and the carrier context, not by later satisfaction or regret.

Verdict. On the stated facts, where the inspected item is material to the transaction, no commitment to the substituted item attaches. This is a bundle-identity/access defect without authorship displacement by a fraudster. Remedy and loss allocation remain downstream.

18.7 Case 6: child promise and complex guarantee

Facts. The same child makes two undertakings: to feed a pet that evening, and to guarantee a complex long-term commercial debt.

Analysis. AASC does not assign fractional standing. The child can retain standing while exercise conditions differ by bundle. The simple promise is accessible, determinate, and carried in an age-appropriate practice. The guarantee contains identity-relevant risks the child cannot adequately access or take up under the relevant domain.

Verdict. Responsibility-authorship can attach to the simple promise but not to the complex guarantee. The difference is bundle-specific access and carrier recognition, not a scalar amount of free will or a total absence of personhood.

18.8 Case 7: unconscious movement and reflex

Facts. A sleeping person knocks an object from a table; in a second case a person's knee reflex causes contact with another.

Analysis. Standing persists, but there is no current access, uptake, bundle, or commitment carrier. The movements are causally attributable to the body but not authored commitments. A prior bundle can matter - for example, knowingly creating a dangerous condition before sleep - but that is a different commitment event.

Verdict. No new responsibility-authorship attaches to the unconscious or reflex movement. Harm can trigger strict, custodial, or prior-risk doctrines, but those doctrines must not pretend that the movement itself was a commitment.

18.9 Case 8: addiction relapse

Facts. A person with severe addiction obtains and uses a substance after a period of abstinence.

Analysis. Addiction does not automatically erase standing or establish valid uptake. The inquiry separates a prior policy commitment, present access, present carrier control, compulsion, and displacement. Suppose the person understands the conduct, deliberately obtains the substance, and retains meaningful carrier control despite powerful craving. The relapse bundle is authored, though compulsion can mitigate response. Suppose instead an acute state bypasses uptake and produces behavior through a mechanism the bearer cannot control or identify; V3-V4 may fail.

Verdict. On the first facts, responsibility-authorship attaches to the relapse bundle, with strong mitigation left open. On the second, no valid current commitment attaches. The diagnosis is not "addiction means less free" but a finding about the actual token.

18.10 Case 9: direct implantation

Facts. An intervener covertly implants a specific intention and controls the motor sequence through which the apparent agent acts, while preserving outward rationalization.

Analysis. The apparent bearer has standing, but the bundle is imposed, uptake is bypassed, and the carrier is controlled by the intervener. The apparent agent supplies causal machinery, not the operative author relation.

Verdict. Responsibility-authorship for the imposed bundle does not attach to the apparent bearer. It can attach to the manipulator if the manipulator has standing and validly authored the intervention bundle. Residual responsibility can exist for earlier commitments that made the manipulation possible, but it cannot be inferred from the imposed act itself.

18.11 Case 10: Frankfurt blocker inactive

Facts. An intervener would force action A if the bearer were about to reject it, but in the actual sequence the bearer independently undertakes A and the intervener remains inactive.

Analysis. Alternatives are blocked counterfactually, but access, uptake, carrier, bundle identity, and non-displacement hold in the actual sequence. The blocker does not author the actual token.

Verdict. Responsibility-authorship attaches to the bearer. The absence of an accessible alternative does not defeat the actual bearer-bundle relation. This verdict concerns authorship, not every possible claim about moral desert.

18.12 Case 11: Frankfurt intervener active

Facts. The bearer begins to reject A, and the intervener activates a device that substitutes the intention and controls the carrier.

Analysis. Actual intervention changes the source of bundle uptake. The bearer is now an execution channel for the intervener's commitment. The case differs from the inactive blocker not in the number of alternatives but in V6.

Verdict. The apparent bearer does not author A through the controlled token. Authorship is displaced. The intervener becomes the primary candidate author, subject to the same standing and admissibility requirements.

18.13 Case 12: self-induced intoxication

Facts. At time C1 a sober bearer knowingly becomes severely intoxicated despite a standing duty; at C2 the intoxicated bearer causes harm with impaired access and control.

Analysis. The analysis must not fuse C1 and C2. At C1, a risk bundle may be validly authored: undertake intoxication under known conditions and risks. At C2, a specific harmful act may lack adequate uptake or carrier control. The prior bundle can ground responsibility for creating the risk without pretending that the later movement was fully authored.

Verdict. Responsibility attaches at C1 to the risk-creation bundle. C2 authorship is case-specific and may fail. Liability doctrines may trace harm to C1, but the tracing rule is downstream of the authorship classifications.

18.14 Case 13: reckless risk with and without harm

Facts. Two bearers commit to identical reckless conduct. One causes no harm; the other causes severe harm through chance.

Analysis. Both author the same risk bundle. Outcome changes damages and response, not the initial attachment.

Verdict. Responsibility-authorship is identical at the commitment layer. Consequence-sensitive liability can differ, but moral luck does not rewrite which bundle was authored.

18.15 Case 14: automated execution after human authorization

Facts. A board validly adopts a policy and authorizes an automated system to execute it. The system produces a harmful output within the policy's specified operation.

Analysis. The board or institution authors the policy bundle at C1. The automated system is a downstream executor unless a separate account establishes standing. Engineers or operators can author additional local bundles, such as negligent configuration or unauthorized modification.

Verdict. Automation does not absorb the original responsibility relation. C1 remains attached to the authoring institution; local human commitments can add layered responsibility. The harmful output affects consequence analysis but does not retroactively transfer standing to the system.

18.16 Case 15: personal resolution

A person adopts a concrete recovery, study, health, or creative-work policy through a recorded or repeatedly enacted resolution. Standing is present; access and uptake are evidenced by the person's own articulation; the bundle specifies conduct and review conditions; the carrier may be a signed plan, witnessed declaration, or stable implementation policy. Responsibility-authorship can attach even without legal enforceability. Lapse, regret, or later revision does not erase the original token.

18.17 Case 16: apology with undertaking of repair

A sincere apology can carry more than acknowledgment. When the bearer accepts responsibility for a determinate wrong and undertakes repair or non-repetition, the apology functions as a commitment carrier. Formulaic words issued under public-relations pressure may fail uptake or authenticity. Whether forgiveness follows is downstream and does not define whether the undertaking was authored.

18.18 Case 17: friendship promise

One friend promises confidentiality and support under stated conditions. The domain is interpersonal rather than legal. The carrier is the promise plus uptake by the other person; the bundle is determinate enough to guide conduct. Responsibility-authorship attaches if the promise is authentic and understood. Monetary enforceability is irrelevant to the structural result.

18.19 Case 18: moral refusal

A standing bearer refuses participation in specified conduct and adopts a policy of non-cooperation. The refusal can bind even though it produces no positive outcome. The bundle is prohibitory, the carrier is the refusal and associated conduct, and downstream consequences may include sanction or exclusion. The case shows that commitment need not be a contract or an intention to cause an outcome.

18.20 Case 19: artistic undertaking

An artist commits to complete a work under declared constraints, collaborators, and deadlines. Aspiration alone is not enough; a determinate plan, public undertaking, or resource commitment can serve as carrier. Responsibility attaches to the project bundle, while success, quality, reception, and completion remain downstream.

18.21 Case 20: solemn or religious vow

A bearer enters a vow recognized by the relevant practice. AASC does not adjudicate the theology. It asks whether the bearer has standing in the domain, understands the vow-defined bundle, and takes it up through the recognized carrier. The example demonstrates that commitment can be solemn and nonlegal without becoming metaphysical outcome control.

18.22 Case 21: private intention without a carrier

Fact pattern. A person privately forms an intention to help a friend, perhaps even rehearses what to do, but never communicates the undertaking, allocates resources, acts, or adopts a domain-recognized self-binding policy. The friend later claims that a promise existed.

Will. The intention is a genuine practical orientation and may be evidence of concern, negligence, ambivalence, or abandoned planning. It is not yet authored uptake of an interpersonal promise bundle. The person has not taken that bundle up through a responsibility-bearing carrier.

Free. No defect verdict is required because the relevant uptake has not yet been fixed. AASC freedom classifies uptake tokens; it does not transform every private intention into a free or unfree commitment.

Commitment. No interpersonal uptake occurred, no public or self-binding token fixed the bundle, and the friend could not identify a responsibility-bearing undertaking merely from the unexpressed mental state. V4 therefore fails for the attributed promise.

The result changes if the domain recognizes a private act as self-binding - for example, a signed personal directive, resource allocation, recorded resolution, or settled policy with known trigger conditions. In that case the private carrier may fix a commitment even without interpersonal communication. The decisive distinction is not public versus mental; it is whether the token functions as an adequate bearer-bundle carrier under the indexed rules.

Result. No interpersonal promise commitment attaches on the stated facts. The person may still author later omission, deception, or abandonment bundles, and ordinary moral appraisal may consider the private intention. Those are different objects.

Doctrinal lesson. Intention orients agency; authored uptake adopts a bundle; commitment binds it.

18.23 Case 22: desire without commitment

A person strongly desires an outcome yet explicitly refuses to undertake the means or obligations associated with it. Desire supplies motivation but no bundle binding. If the desired outcome occurs by luck, the person does not become its author merely because the desire preceded it.

18.24 Case 23: reasons-responsive action without explicit commitment

A system or person adjusts behavior intelligently to reasons but does not occupy the author role or fix a bundle. Responsiveness may support access and competence, yet it is insufficient for responsibility-authorship without standing, uptake, and fixation. This is a negative control for the reasons-responsiveness comparator.

18.25 Case 24: reactive blame without a valid authorship object

A group blames a convenient target after harm, but the evidence shows forgery, displacement, or no commitment carrier. The reactive attitude is real and causally consequential, yet it cannot create the missing bearer-bundle relation. Sanction without authorship must be justified, if at all, on another doctrine.

18.26 Case 25: failure to warn after accepting a safety role

Fact pattern. A bearer accepts a safety-monitoring role that includes a duty to warn when a specified danger threshold is met. The threshold is met, the bearer has access and capacity to issue the warning, and no warning is given.

Will. The responsibility-relevant uptake is not the later non-event considered in isolation. It is the earlier authored uptake of the safety-role bundle, including the duty to warn under specified conditions, plus any later refusal, abandonment, or non-revision token that the domain recognizes.

Free. The omission is AASC-free only if the role/bundle relation remains valid, non-displaced, non-laundered, and carrier-adequate. If a superior disables the warning channel, fraudulently conceals the threshold, or coerces silence, the omission analysis shifts to access, carrier, or displacement defects.

Commitment. Non-action itself is not a carrier. The carrier is the prior accepted duty, role, policy, or undertaking under which non-performance becomes attributable.

Result. Responsibility-authorship can attach to the safety-role bundle or to a later refusal bundle, not to bare nonoccurrence. Harm, damages, punishment, excuse, and mitigation remain downstream.

Doctrinal lesson. Omission is analyzed through indexed bundle failure, not through metaphysical authorship of a blank.

18.27 Cross-case result

The cases establish a stable pattern. Constraint alone does not defeat authorship. Causation alone does not establish displacement. Formal appearance alone does not establish a carrier. Standing alone does not attach a bundle. Outcome alone does not create or erase commitment. Bare nonoccurrence alone does not create authorship; omission becomes responsibility-relevant only through an indexed role, duty, policy, undertaking, or refusal bundle. The decisive question is whether the complete bearer-bundle-carrier relation was validly fixed.

Part VI - Responsibility, Law, and Governance

19. Responsibility Without Desert Inflation

19.1 Four layers

AASC separates four layers often compressed into “responsibility”:

1. **Authorship:** who bound itself to what bundle?
2. **Answerability:** who may be required to explain or justify the commitment?
3. **Liability:** what legal, institutional, or remedial consequences attach?
4. **Desert:** what praise, blame, punishment, or reward is intrinsically deserved?

The central theorem establishes the first. It can support the others, but does not entail them. A valid author may have a justification, an excuse, immunity, limitation period, release, or reason for mercy. An institution may impose strict liability without proving a commitment to harm. These doctrines should not be mistaken for counterexamples to the attachment theorem because they answer different questions.

19.2 Authorship before sanction and desert sequencing

Theorem FW-T14 - Responsibility Prior to Sanction. A sanction, demand, or remedial response cannot by itself create responsibility-authorship. It must either presuppose an independently valid bearer-bundle relation or operate under a distinct non-authorship doctrine such as strict liability.

Theorem FW-T20 - Authorship Priority over Desert. Desert, blame, punishment, forgiveness, excuse, mitigation, compensation, liability, and repair presuppose an identifiable responsibility-authorship relation or an explicitly different basis of response. A later normative or institutional response cannot create the prior bearer-bundle relation by declaration.

Theorem FW-T25 - Desert Sequencing. Any action-directed theory of retributive, consequentialist, restorative, skeptical, communicative, protective, or mixed response must either identify a responsibility-authorship object or expressly justify response on a non-authorship basis. Disagreement about what is deserved occurs downstream of the bearer-bundle fixation question.

Proof sketch. Desert and blame require a target. An action-directed target requires a relation between a bearer and an attributed object. That relation requires identification of the bearer, bundle, carrier, and fixation event. AASC supplies those through standing, admissibility, carrier adequacy, commitment, and non-displacement. A later response can recognize, contest, excuse, forgive, mitigate, or misidentify the relation, but it cannot constitute the earlier authorship without reversing

temporal order. A response theory can avoid the authorship premise only by candidly grounding intervention elsewhere - for example in prevention, risk, need, compensation, or strict liability.

The sequencing theorem is neutral among downstream moral and legal programs. A retributivist can argue that some validly authored wrongful bundles deserve punishment. A consequentialist can treat authorship as one input into deterrence or institutional design. A restorative theory can use it to localize answerability and repair. A skeptic can deny basic desert while retaining factual authorship, forward-looking protection, and reconciliation. A mixed theory can combine these. What none may do is infer the prior author relation from the preferred response.

The theorem prevents punishment from becoming proof. A state's decision to sanction does not establish that the target authored the bundle. Nor does forgiveness erase authorship, or skepticism about retribution erase the historical commitment. AASC does not evade desert; it orders the problem: first identify the authorship object, then ask what, if anything, is deserved or otherwise justified.

Theorem FW-T26 - Desert Target. Desert, blame, punishment, excuse, mitigation, compensation, forgiveness, release, and repair presuppose a responsibility-authorship object or an expressly non-authorship basis of response. AASC supplies the authorship target; downstream moral, legal, and social theory determines what, if anything, follows.

AASC is not a desert theory, but every action-directed desert theory needs an authorship target. Retributive, consequentialist, restorative, skeptical, communicative, protective, and mixed accounts can disagree about what follows after responsibility attaches. None can bypass the prior question of whether a standing bearer authored the relevant commitment bundle. Desert without an authorship object has no stable target.

19.3 Blame and reactive attitudes

Blame can be appropriate, inappropriate, excessive, or misdirected. Reactive attitudes may track perceived authorship, but they do not constitute it. A community can blame a scapegoat. A victim can forgive a responsible author. A bearer can accept responsibility without deserving retribution. The structural relation remains analytically prior.

19.4 Justification and excuse

Justification generally evaluates the bundle: was the conduct permissible or required under the circumstances? Excuse evaluates the bearer's relation to an impermissible bundle: did access, uptake, carrier, or displacement undermine blame or liability? The distinction is not perfect across all legal and moral theories, but it maps naturally onto AASC.

A justified emergency action may be fully authored. An excused coerced action may have a defective or mitigated author relation depending on the domain. The theory does not force every excuse into invalid commitment; some excuses operate downstream while authorship remains.

19.5 Forgiveness, release, and repair

Forgiveness does not make the commitment unauthored. Release can terminate an obligation's continuing force. Restitution can repair consequences. Reconciliation can transform relationships. These are later governance acts compatible with historical irreversibility.

19.6 Moral luck revisited

AASC offers a partial response to moral luck by separating authored risk from realized consequence. It cannot remove constitutive or circumstantial luck from human life. Nor does it prove that outcome-sensitive punishment is unjust. It identifies the point at which luck begins to affect downstream evaluation rather than authorship.

19.7 Proportionality

Proportionality requires additional variables: severity, foreseeability, intent, harm, vulnerability, institutional purpose, and alternatives. AASC supplies the commitment bundle as one input. It does not derive a proportionality function. This explicit non-derivation is part of the analysis boundary.

20. Legal and Institutional Legibility

20.1 Why legal systems need attachment points

Law cannot operate solely on causal contribution (Hart 1968; Hart and Honoré 1985). It distinguishes acts from accidents, authority from execution, attempt from completion, consent from mere compliance, and principal from agent. These distinctions presuppose a way to localize authorship. AASC provides a general structure without claiming to replace positive law.

20.2 Contract

A contract-like commitment can be represented as:

$$C_D(a,B,k,t)$$

where **a** is an authorized party, **B** contains the agreed terms and incorporated defaults, **k** is an accepted manifestation, and **t** is formation. Performance and breach are downstream. Fraud, duress, mistake, incapacity, and lack of authority map to the validity conditions.

The analogy has limits. Not every free-will commitment is contractual, bilateral, voluntary in the legal sense, or enforceable. Contract is useful because it makes carrier and bundle identity explicit.

20.3 Criminal responsibility

Criminal law typically requires conduct, a culpable mental state for relevant elements, causation for result offenses, and the absence of applicable defenses (American Law Institute 1962; Hart 1968). AASC can organize these without collapsing them. The commitment bundle may include purpose, knowledge, recklessness, or a policy of omission. The prohibited result remains downstream. Attempt doctrines demonstrate that authorship can precede completion.

The framework must not be used to bypass safeguards. It does not prove mens rea from outcome, infer standing from accusation, or eliminate reasonable doubt. It clarifies why those safeguards concern the integrity of attribution.

20.4 Consent

Consent is a paradigmatic bearer–bundle binding. Valid consent requires an eligible bearer or authorized representative, identity-relevant access, uptake, an adequate carrier, and non-displacement. The outcome of treatment cannot retroactively create consent. A good result after unauthorized intervention does not validate the original token; an adverse result after valid informed consent does not prove non-consent.

This does not make consent unlimited. The envelope can exclude certain transactions, and legal or ethical rules can restrict what can be authorized. A bearer cannot enlarge the envelope merely by willing.

20.5 Fiduciary and professional roles

Professionals often commit to role-defined policy bundles. A physician, trustee, lawyer, engineer, or officer does not select every outcome. Responsibility attaches to authorizations, standards, disclosures, risk decisions, and departures. Delegated tasks remain downstream unless the delegate makes an independent commitment.

20.6 Corporate and collective action

Organizations act through structured carriers: votes, resolutions, policies, authorized signatures, and procedures (List and Pettit 2011). AASC can represent institutional authorship without pretending the organization is reducible to whichever employee executes the result. The domain determines which role has authority to bind the collective bundle.

Collective standing raises questions beyond this paper. The minimal claim is conditional: where a domain recognizes a standing-bearing institution, valid authorization localizes commitment at the institutional bearer. The theory does not infer institutional standing merely from size, intelligence, or causal power.

20.7 Omissions and duties

An omission becomes attributable when a prior duty or policy bundle specifies action under the relevant condition and the bearer had access and capacity to perform. Bare nonoccurrence is not enough. This distinction is important in institutional failures where responsibility can otherwise dissolve into “the system.” Analysis should identify who authored which standing instruction and who later committed to depart from it. The omission carrier is therefore not silence as such; it is the prior or standing bearer-bundle relation that makes non-performance an attributable failure.

20.8 Governance theorem

Theorem FW-T15 — Governance Legibility. A responsibility system is traceable only if it can identify a standing bearer, a determinate bundle, an adequate carrier, a fixation point, and the distinction between authorship and downstream execution.

A system can choose different substantive norms, but if it cannot answer those five questions, attribution will depend on outcome, status, or retrospective narrative rather than a stable object.

20.9 Institutional design implications

The theorem supports several design principles without making them universally mandatory:

- record authorization before execution when stakes are high;
- separate policy approval from implementation logs;
- preserve bundle versions and effective dates;
- document delegation scope;
- identify revocation and supersession as new events;
- prevent outcome-based alteration of original records;
- distinguish evidentiary confidence from the classification itself.

These are governance implications, not the metaphysical definition of freedom.

21. Delegation and Automation as a Limited Stress Test

21.1 Deliberately limited scope

Automation is not the paper's focus. It appears because it sharply exposes the difference between authoring a bundle and executing it. The theory does not decide whether any present or future artificial system has standing. It rejects only the inference from technical competence or causal autonomy to standing.

21.2 Delegated execution

A standing bearer can commit to a bundle and authorize another process or agent to implement it. Delegation changes the execution path, not the historical author relation. The delegate may also make independent commitments within or beyond the delegated scope. Structural analysis must therefore distinguish layers rather than assign all responsibility to the first or last node.

Theorem FW-T16 — Delegation Non-Transfer. Delegation can transfer or distribute execution authority within an admissible bundle, but it does not transfer canonical standing or erase the delegator's responsibility-authorship for the bundle originally committed to.

21.3 Automated recommendation

A system may recommend a course of action. If a standing bearer reviews and takes up the recommendation, the bearer can author the resulting bundle. If institutional policy automatically adopts recommendations, responsibility may attach to the policy commitment made earlier. The system's causal influence does not decide standing.

21.4 Automated execution

An automated process may implement a policy at speed and scale. Failures can arise from defective design bundles, inadequate monitoring commitments, unauthorized local changes, or unforeseeable downstream events. The framework's value is diagnostic: it directs inquiry to policy authors, local authors, carrier logs, and scope boundaries.

21.5 Why the tangent ends here

These examples do not convert free will into an AI-governance theory. They demonstrate one point: execution sophistication cannot substitute for standing-bound authorship. Questions about machine

standing, consciousness, rights, and personhood require separate arguments and are expressly deferred.

22. What the AASC Answer Changes

The reconstruction changes the free-will problem in nine concrete ways.

1. **Metaphysical exception is unnecessary.** Responsibility-bearing agency does not require an extra force outside causal explanation. Causal processes realize carriers; they do not replace the authorship relation merely by causing it.
2. **Determinism has a specified burden.** Determinism defeats free will only if it entails failure of standing, access, uptake, carrier adequacy, bundle admissibility, fixation, or non-displacement. It cannot win by relabeling caused commitment as non-authorship.
3. **Randomness provides no rescue.** Stochastic transition can vary outcome but cannot possess standing, take up a bundle, or become bound to it.
4. **Alternative possibilities are relocated.** Alternatives describe the envelope and can matter to evidence, fairness, coercion, and deliberation. They are not the constitutive attachment point.
5. **Outcome luck is separated from authorship.** Harm, success, damages, and sanction may depend on outcome. The historical bearer-bundle relation does not become a different relation merely because luck changes consequences.
6. **Coercion becomes a defect analysis.** Constraint is universal. Coercion matters when it corrupts access, uptake, carrier adequacy, bundle identity, or non-displacement, not because it subtracts an unspecified quantity of freedom.
7. **Commitment is generalized without becoming legalistic.** Promises, refusals, plans, personal resolutions, vows, apologies, policies, and authorizations can all carry commitment when the constitutive relation is satisfied. Signature is one carrier, not the essence.
8. **Desert is sequenced rather than smuggled into the definition.** AASC supplies the prior authorship object while leaving retributive, restorative, consequentialist, skeptical, and mixed response theories to defend their additional premises.
9. **Execution is distinguished from authorship.** Delegation and automation can alter implementation, scale, and causal complexity without automatically transferring standing or relocating the original commitment.

These changes explain why the account is revisionary but remains an answer to free will. It does not conserve every intuition attached to the phrase. It preserves the responsibility-bearing authorship

role that makes the phrase institutionally, morally, and interpersonally consequential, then eliminates roles that cannot coherently occupy that target.

The philosophical payoff is therefore not the slogan that determinism and freedom are compatible. It is the stronger diagnosis that the traditional dispute often places responsibility at the wrong structural location. Once capacity, exercise, attachment, realization, and response are separated, the demand for outcome-selecting freedom loses its function.

22.1 The semantic payoff

The reconstruction now gives positive content to both terms rather than relying only on elimination. **Will** is directed uptake that satisfies the independent conditions for indexed authorship occupancy. **Free** is the valid, non-displaced occupation of that relation under constraint. Free will is the standing-bound capacity for such uptake; commitment fixes it; responsibility-authorship attaches to the fixed bundle. Because directed uptake is specified before the authorship verdict, the decomposition does not redescribe free will by assumption.

Part VII - Objections and Replies

23. Objection: “This Is Just Compatibilism”

The objection notes that AASC allows responsibility under determinism and concludes that the theory is a form of compatibilism. The conclusion is understandable but incomplete.

AASC shares an invariance result with compatibilism. It does not define freedom as acting on one’s desires, higher-order endorsement, or reasons-responsive control. Those properties can support access and uptake, but the central object is a governance relation. The theory also refuses to make “free will and determinism are compatible” its organizing question. It first decomposes the target, then shows that determinism bears on downstream causation rather than the attachment relation unless an additional defect premise is supplied.

The most accurate statement is:

AASC reaches a compatibilist-looking conclusion by a role-separation route that is not itself a conventional control theory.

This difference is testable in cases where control and authorship diverge. An authorized principal can author a policy without controlling every outcome. A non-standing mechanism can control an output without authoring it. The relations are not coextensive.

24. Objection: “The Account Eliminates Real Free Will”

If “real free will” is defined as a metaphysical power to select outcomes outside the causal order, the account does eliminate it. That is an intended result, not a hidden concession. The paper argues that such a power is not required for the governance role and introduces liabilities of its own.

If “real free will” means a bearer’s capacity to own commitments, answer for them, revise them, and distinguish its author role from mere execution, the account preserves and formalizes it. The disagreement is partly verbal, but not merely verbal: AASC supplies explicit attachment and traceability conditions that outcome-control language lacks.

The theory therefore does not present itself as saving every pretheoretical intuition. It offers a replacement object with a declared scope.

25. Objection: “Freedom Under Constraint Is a Contradiction”

The objection assumes freedom means absence of constraint. Yet an unconstrained act would have no domain, no identity, no bearer boundary, and no difference between one commitment and another. Constraints are what make a bundle determinate. Language, law, embodiment, causation, and social roles are not necessarily enemies of agency; they are conditions under which commitment can be legible.

AASC does not equate all constraints with legitimate constraints. Coercion, domination, and exclusion can corrupt commitment. The point is that their wrongness cannot be explained by the mere presence of constraint, because all action has constraints. The analysis must identify the defective relation.

26. Objection: “If Determinism Causes the Commitment, Responsibility Vanishes”

This objection adds an ultimate-source premise: a caused commitment cannot be authored. But causation and authorship answer different questions. A statement can be caused by neural and social processes and still be the authenticated carrier of a standing bearer’s uptake. To infer invalidity, the critic must show that causation defeats access, uptake, carrier adequacy, admissibility, or non-displacement.

The objection gains force if it concerns desert rather than authorship. AASC concedes that ultimate desert is not derived. Determinism may support restraint, compassion, or revision of punishment. Those conclusions do not erase the commitment record.

27. Objection: “Commitment Cannot Handle Coercion”

A bare commitment theory might say that any signed or performed act binds. AASC does not. Carrier adequacy and non-displacement are constitutive. Coercion can make the token a vehicle for the coercer’s bundle rather than the victim’s uptake.

The framework also avoids overcorrection. Severe pressure does not automatically mean no authorship. A person in an emergency can author a justified response. The domain must classify the defect and any excuse. This is more exact than a scalar voluntariness score.

28. Objection: “The Account Is Merely Legalistic”

The vocabulary of standing, admissibility, and commitment has legal resonance, but the structure is more general. Any responsibility practice must distinguish authors from causal channels, commitments from outcomes, and valid carriers from noise. Law makes these needs visible because it institutionalizes them.

The account does not derive standing from legal recognition or treat legality as admissibility. An unjust legal order can misrecognize standing, validate wrongful envelopes, and assign sanctions without authorship. The canonical relation provides a standard by which institutional practice can be criticized.

29. Objection: “The Account Ignores Conscious Experience”

The theory brackets phenomenology at the constitutive level. It does not deny experiences of effort, conflict, ownership, or alienation. Such experiences may be crucial evidence about access, uptake, and compulsion. They may also be independently valuable topics.

The bracketing is methodological. A private feeling cannot alone specify a public bundle, institutional authority, or authentic carrier. Conversely, lack of vivid deliberative feeling does not negate a standing policy commitment. Skilled action and settled plans often operate without episodic phenomenology.

30. Objection: “The Account Cannot Explain Moral Desert”

Correct: the account does not derive a complete theory of desert. It identifies responsibility-authorship. A further moral theory must explain why authored wrongdoing warrants blame or punishment, how luck and social formation affect desert, and what forms of response are justified.

This limitation prevents circularity. If the definition of free will included whatever is necessary for deserved punishment, the theory would build its conclusion into the target. AASC instead supplies a prior object that retributivists, consequentialists, restorative theories, and skeptics can evaluate differently.

30.1 Further objection: commitment is too formal

A critic may argue that a governance relation is too thin to capture agency. The reply is that thinness is deliberate at the attachment layer. Rich psychology enters through access, uptake, and carrier

evidence; moral identity enters in evaluative layers. The formal core prevents those contingent features from shifting the attachment point after outcomes.

30.2 Further objection: standing is unexplained

Standing is primitive within this paper. That is a genuine theoretical cost. The corpus treats it as canonical, binary, conserved, and non-delegable. A naturalistic, moral, or institutional account of why particular entities have standing is deferred. The present theorem derives consequences from standing; it does not independently establish its extension.

A rigorous presentation requires this admission. Without it, the theory would appear to solve agency by hiding it in a word. The reply is not that standing is self-evident, but that the author-role predicate must be declared somewhere and cannot be inferred from causal performance alone.

30.3 Further objection: bundles are too coarse

A single action can instantiate many descriptions. Which bundle is “the” commitment? AASC answers with domain-indexed identity. The governing rules, bearer access, and carrier determine which descriptions are identity-relevant. There may be multiple valid commitments at different levels. The theory should not force one universal grain.

This pluralism is constrained by no post-selection repair. The grain cannot be chosen after the outcome merely to maximize or minimize responsibility.

Part VIII - Exhaustion, Counterexamples, and Closure

31. Failure-Mode Analysis

The following table summarizes the recurrent failure modes and the rule that blocks each one.

Failure mode	Symptom	AASC diagnosis	Blocking rule	Result
Outcome control reintroduced	Freedom defined by success	Commitment confused with realization	FW-T01, FW-T05	Reject identity
Causal selector imported	Agent “chooses” actuality	Unlicensed extra force	P8, FW-T05	Eliminate selector
Alternative possibility made primitive	No alternatives, no responsibility	Envelope confused with authorship	FW-T09	Alternatives non-necessary
Responsibility attached to outcome	Luck rewrites author	Post-selection repair	FW-T04, FW-C02	Fix at commitment
Envelope-wide commitment	“Whatever happens”	No determinate object	FW-T02	Invalid target
Post hoc bundle	Intent reconstructed from result	Identity fixed too late	FW-D04, V5	Reject repair
Standing delegated	Executor treated as author by task transfer	Standing/execution collapse	FW-T16	Preserve author locus
Standing inferred from performance	Sophistication creates personhood	Competence/standing collapse	FW-D01	Inference blocked
Temporary impairment erases personhood	Fluctuation treated as partial standing	Standing/exercise collapse	§14	Analyze V2–V4
Coercion treated as any constraint	Hard choice equals no agency	Constraint/defect collapse	FW-T12	Classify component
Manipulation treated as any influence	All causation displaces	Cause/authorship collapse	§16	Require substitution
Ignorance ignored	Hidden bundle attributed	Access failure	FW-T13	Re-identify bundle
Good outcome validates defect	Benefit cures fraud or coercion	Outcome repair	No post-selection	Invalid remains invalid
Bad outcome proves invalidity	Regret becomes incapacity	Hindsight reclassification	Historical irreversibility	Original token preserved
Consciousness treated as sufficient	Feeling creates authority	Phenomenology/carrier collapse	V1–V6	Evidence only
Determinism treated as universal excuse	Cause means no author	Determination/displacement collapse	FW-T07	Additional premise required
Branching fragments authorship	Each outcome creates a new author	Outcome/bundle confusion	FW-T08	Bundle-indexing
Automation absorbs responsibility	Last executor treated as source	Execution/authorship collapse	FW-T16	Layered attribution
Sanction treated as proof	Punishment creates guilt	Response/authorship reversal	FW-T14	Independent proof required
Desert treated as primitive	Authorship defined by blame	Normative inflation	§19	Separate layers

32. Same-Scope Counterexamples and Refutation Conditions

32.1 Why refutation conditions matter

A structural theory becomes insulated if every objection is dismissed as outside scope. The AASC answer therefore states what would count as a genuine same-scope counterexample. A counterexample must preserve target R: it must concern responsibility-bearing authorship in the

same fixed domain, not phenomenology alone, causal explanation alone, or a different theory of desert.

Theorem FW-T21 - Same-Scope Refutation Burden. The AASC free-will answer is refuted or materially incomplete if a same-scope case satisfies target R while violating a constitutive AASC claim, if an AASC-valid commitment systematically fails to supply one of R's functions, or if a rival object supplies the complete bearer-object-fixation relation without reducing to standing-bound admissible commitment.

Counterexample form	Required showing	AASC claim at risk
A	Responsibility-authorship without standing	Standing necessity
B	Valid commitment without a determinate admissible bundle	Bundle target and V5
C	Responsibility-authorship without any commitment event	Carrier/fixation necessity
D	Outcome constitutes prior authorship without retrospective repair	Outcome independence
E	Delegation transfers canonical standing without role laundering	Standing conservation
F	A non-commitment object fully occupies R	Same-scope exhaustion
G	Randomness itself functions as an author	Randomness non-authorship
H	Determinism alone defeats authorship without any validity failure	Determinism invariance

32.2 Form A: authorship without standing

A successful case would identify a responsibility-bearing author that lacks standing under the declared domain while avoiding mere causal execution, institutional fiction, or covert redefinition of standing. A machine producing an output is not enough. The case must show why the machine, rather than its designer, operator, institution, or causal process, is bearer of the commitment bundle. Conversely, independently assigning the machine standing changes the premise classification rather than refuting standing necessity.

32.3 Form B: valid commitment without a determinate admissible bundle

A successful case would show a bearer becoming responsibility-bound while no determinate object can be identified and no rule-defined bundle is implicit. Envelope-wide aspiration, vague desire, or retrospective interpretation is insufficient. If responsibility can attach without any object, FW-T02 and V5 fail.

32.4 Form C: responsibility-authorship without a commitment event

A successful case would identify a prior bearer-bundle relation without access, uptake, carrier, or fixation. Strict liability does not automatically qualify because it can impose response without

asserting authorship of the harmful event. Vicarious liability does not qualify unless it claims the principal authored the specific bundle without prior authorization, policy, or assumption of risk.

32.5 Form D: outcome-constituted authorship without post-selection repair

A successful case would show that realized outcome is constitutive of who authored the earlier bundle while the bundle and carrier remain unchanged and no retrospective reclassification occurs. Consequence-sensitive damages, offense grading, or blame do not qualify; those are downstream responses. If such a case is coherent, outcome independence is false.

32.6 Form E: delegated standing without role laundering

A successful case would show execution delegation creating or transferring canonical standing rather than authorizing performance within a prior bundle. The new bearer must receive the original author's standing as such, not independently possess standing or make a new commitment. If possible, standing conservation and FW-T16 fail.

32.7 Form F: a rival object that fully occupies R

The strongest refutation would identify a non-AASC object that supplies author eligibility, object identity, fixation, historical persistence, and separation from execution without reducing to standing-bound commitment. The rival must also classify coercion, fraud, unconscious movement, manipulation, failed attempts, branching, and outcome luck without borrowing the AASC carrier or post-selection discipline.

Reasons-responsiveness, hierarchical endorsement, planning, consciousness, causal control, alternative possibilities, and indeterminism remain candidate components. They become complete rivals only if they perform every R function without covertly importing standing, bundle identity, carrier, or fixation.

32.8 Form G: randomness functioning as authorship

A successful case would show a random or stochastic transition that possesses author eligibility, takes up a determinate object, and becomes bound to it. Showing merely that chance changes which outcome occurs is insufficient. Unless randomness itself can occupy the author role, it remains part of causal realization rather than free will.

32.9 Form H: determinism defeating authorship without a validity failure

A successful case would derive the absence of responsibility-authorship from determinism alone while leaving standing, access, uptake, carrier adequacy, bundle admissibility, fixation, and non-displacement intact. If determinism can negate authorship without touching any constitutive condition, FW-T07 is false. If an additional premise is needed - for example, that caused commitment is never authored - that premise must be defended independently.

32.10 Internal failure conditions

The theory can fail from within. It fails if standing is incoherent or cannot be individuated without circular reference to free will; if admissibility collapses into moral approval; if bundle identity is always retrospectively determined; if carrier adequacy depends on outcome; if the free-will/responsibility bridge fails; or if case classifications contradict one another under the same domain rules.

Mere dissatisfaction with the absence of metaphysical spontaneity is not a same-scope counterexample. A counterexample must supply or defeat a responsibility-authorship structure. This burden is demanding because the claim is structural, but it is not impossible: reject a premise, defeat a proof, show inconsistency, or provide a complete rival.

33. Final AASC Free-Will Theorem

The argument can now be stated in its final form.

Theorem FW-T22 - Final AASC Free-Will Theorem. In any fixed AASC domain governed by canonical standing, bivalent structural admissibility, determinate constraint bundles, adequate commitment carriers, historically irreversible fixation, and no post-selection repair, free will is the standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the independently specified conditions for admissible indexed authorship and become fixed as commitment. It is **will** because a bearer-directed token becomes authored uptake when the eligible bearer has identity-relevant access, an adequate carrier, an admissible bundle, and no displacing author. It is **free** because the bearer validly and non-displacedly occupies that indexed authorship relation under constraint, not because it escapes causation. “The bearer’s own” denotes relational authorship occupancy, not subjective enthusiasm, higher-order endorsement, phenomenological ownership, legal title, or ultimate self-origination. Commitment is the historically irreversible fixation of valid authored uptake. Responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation. Determinism, branching, randomness, delegated execution, and outcome variance do not erase or relocate authorship unless they produce a specific failure of standing, access, directed uptake, carrier adequacy, bundle admissibility, fixation, or non-displacement. Causation, outcome, luck, execution, desert, sanction, and institutional response remain downstream.

The theorem is not a proof of libertarian outcome-control. It denies that outcome-control is the relevant author role. It is not ordinary compatibilism. It does not define freedom as a special kind of causal control and then reconcile that control with determinism. It is not free-will skepticism. It preserves a responsibility-bearing capacity, a positive account of will, a positive relational account of freedom, and a fixation event while rejecting metaphysical inflation.

The theorem is conditional but substantive. Given the AASC primitives, a rival cannot preserve target R merely by naming alternatives, sourcehood, consciousness, reasons, planning, or causal openness. It must provide the complete bearer-directed token, independent authorship conditions, carrier, fixation relation, and historical stability, and it must survive the hard cases without post-selection repair.

The shortest doctrinal statement is:

Directed uptake = bearer-directed orientation toward a bundle without an authorship verdict. Authored uptake = directed uptake satisfying the indexed authorship conditions. Free = valid non-displaced authorship occupancy. Will = authored uptake. Free will = the standing-bound capacity for such uptake. Commitment = irreversible fixation. Responsibility-authorship = attachment to the fixed bundle. Causal realization and outcome = downstream.

The AASC Answer to Free Will

Free will is the standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can qualify as admissible authored uptake of a determinate constraint bundle.

It is free because the bearer validly and non-displacedly occupies the indexed authorship relation under constraint, not because it escapes constraint.

It is will because directed uptake satisfies the independent authorship conditions, not because a mental state selects outcomes.

Commitment is the historically irreversible fixation of that authored uptake.

Responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation.

Causation, consequence, branching, luck, execution, desert, sanction, and moral appraisal remain downstream and do not relocate authorship.

34. Closure

The traditional free-will object is unstable because it is asked to be a capacity, mental state, event, cause, selector, source of normativity, and explanation of outcome. AASC separates the jobs. Standing supplies author eligibility. Directed uptake identifies a bearer-directed relation to a determinate bundle without assuming authorship. Indexed authorship occupancy tests standing, access, carrier adequacy, admissibility, and non-displacement. Authored uptake is the directed token once those conditions hold. Free will is the capacity for such uptake. Commitment is its historically

irreversible fixation. The constraint bundle is the responsibility object. Responsibility-authorship attaches at fixation. Causal implementation and outcome remain downstream.

This decomposition changes the central inquiry. The question is not whether a bearer escaped causation or generated an unconditioned future. It is whether a bearer-directed token existed, whether an eligible standing bearer had identity-relevant access to the bundle, whether an adequate carrier manifested that token, whether the bundle was admissible, whether another source displaced the apparent author, and whether fixation occurred. These questions can be difficult in fact, but they have stable objects and explicit failure conditions.

The answer survives determinism because causal explanation does not by itself displace indexed authorship. It survives branching because multiple outcomes do not multiply the initial commitment. It handles Frankfurt cases because removal of alternatives differs from substitution of directed uptake. It handles coercion, manipulation, addiction, ignorance, and incapacity by locating component defects rather than assigning a vague amount of freedom. It remains institutionally legible because authorship and execution are separate.

Nothing in the theorem guarantees that standing is easy to ground, that every domain is just, or that punishment is deserved. Those are further questions. The contribution is prior: AASC identifies the capacity, directed token, authorship relation, commitment event, and responsibility object that free-will discourse requires without invoking metaphysical outcome selection. The account is deliberately revisionary. It is not a semantic conservation project, and it does not promise that every pretheoretical or theological use of free will survives. It remains an answer to free will rather than a change of subject because it gives positive AASC content to both terms and derives authored uptake from independently contestable conditions.

Free will survives in AASC not as an exception to causation, but as the standing-bound capacity for valid, non-displaced authored uptake of a determinate responsibility-bearing constraint bundle.

Appendix A - Formal Definitions and Symbols

A.1 Core symbols

Symbol	Meaning
R	Responsibility-authorship target role
D	Fixed governance domain
A_D	Candidate bearers in D
E_D	Constraint envelope fixed relative to the event
a	Candidate standing bearer
B	Constraint bundle
k	Commitment carrier
t	Fixation time or interval
o	Downstream outcome
S(a)	a has standing
A(a,B)	a has identity-relevant access to B
U_D(a,B,k)	directed uptake of B through k
O_D(a,B,k)	indexed authorship occupancy
AU_D(a,B,k)	authored uptake: directed uptake under O_D
K(k,a,B)	k adequately carries the directed-uptake token
M(B,E_D)	B is contained in E_D
I(B)	B is internally coherent
F(U,t)	uptake is fixed without post-selection repair
N(a,B,k)	authorship is not displaced
C_D(a,B,k,t)	valid commitment token
Resp_D(a,B,t)	responsibility-authorship relation

A.2 Definition ledger

FW-D00 Responsibility-authorship target. The same-scope role identifying author eligibility, authored object, fixation, historical persistence, and separation from outcome realization.

FW-D01 Standing. The non-delegable, conserved author-role predicate.

FW-D02 Admissibility. Structural eligibility of a candidate bundle for responsibility-bearing commitment; not moral permission.

FW-D03 Constraint envelope. The domain-fixed space of admissible targets and individuation rules available before retrospective outcome repair.

FW-D04 Historical irreversibility. A valid commitment token remains part of history even when later altered in force.

FW-D05 Constraint bundle. A determinate, coherent, non-retrospective commitment target within the envelope.

FW-D06 Free will. The standing-bound capacity for directed uptake that can satisfy the conditions for admissible indexed authorship and become fixed as commitment.

FW-D07 Commitment. The historically irreversible fixation of valid authored uptake through an adequate carrier.

FW-D08 Responsibility-authorship. The relation attaching bearer to authored bundle at fixation.

FW-D09 Downstream causation. Causal implementation, frustration, transformation, and outcome evolution relative to fixation.

FW-D10 Commitment carrier. The domain-recognized token or process that manifests, authenticates, and fixes uptake.

FW-D11 Authored uptake. Directed uptake satisfying the independent conditions for indexed authorship occupancy.

FW-D12 AASC-free uptake. Authored uptake in which the standing bearer validly and non-displacedly occupies the indexed authorship relation.

FW-D13 AASC relational ownership. The bearer's indexed author position for the relevant uptake token, not psychological, proprietary, causal-originate, or metaphysical ownership.

FW-D14 Directed uptake. Bearer-directed adoption, authorization, undertaking, or refusal with respect to a determinate bundle, described without presupposing authorship or freedom.

FW-D15 Indexed authorship occupancy. The relational status obtained when directed uptake has an eligible standing bearer, identity-relevant access, an adequate carrier, an admissible bundle, and no displacing author.

A.3 Validity formula

$$O_D(a,B,k) \leftrightarrow S(a) \wedge A(a,B) \wedge K(k,a,B) \wedge M(B,E_D) \wedge I(B) \wedge N(a,B,k).$$

$$AU_D(a,B,k) \leftrightarrow U_D(a,B,k) \wedge O_D(a,B,k).$$

$$C_D(a,B,k,t) \leftrightarrow AU_D(a,B,k) \wedge F(U,t).$$

$$C_D(a,B,k,t) \rightarrow \text{Resp_D}(a,B,t).$$

The first formula states the independent indexed-occupancy conditions, the second classifies directed uptake as authored, and the third distinguishes authored uptake from its historically fixing commitment event. The no-post-selection rule is enforced by **F** at fixation. The converse is definitional only when **Resp** is reserved for responsibility-authorship. Broader strict or vicarious liability can arise on other grounds.

A.4 Status of the formalism

The notation is an authorship-and-governance model, not a physical dynamics. It assigns no probabilities, energies, utilities, or causal strengths. Its bivalence concerns structural admission. Empirical inquiry supplies evidence for the predicates. U, O, and AU separate directed uptake, indexed authorship occupancy, and authored uptake; they do not add causal forces.

Appendix B - Theorem and Lemma Ledger

The ledger distinguishes core theorems from bridge, comparator, and methodological lemmas. Every row states a counterexample burden rather than treating the result as self-certifying.

B.1 Core theorems

ID	Theorem	Principal dependencies	Counterexample condition
FW-T01	Role Separation	D01; D06–D09; P1–P8	Exhibit a role identity that preserves all target-R functions without collapse or outcome dependence.
FW-T02	Bundle Target	D03; D05; V5	Specify an envelope-wide object that excludes conduct and fixes responsibility without becoming a bundle or rule.
FW-T03	Internal Coherence	D02; D05; no-repair rule	Provide auditable identity for a contradictory target without decomposition or priority rules.
FW-T04	Responsibility Attachment	D07; D08; V1–V6	Identify a different constitutive attachment point not already presupposing fixation.
FW-T05	No Outcome Selection	D06–D09; P8	License an outcome selector essential to authorship and non-duplicative of causation.
FW-T06	Conditional Same-Scope Exhaustion of the AASC Free-Will Role	D00; P1–P8; T01–T05; T17–T19	Exhibit a same-scope rival satisfying eligible-author, determinate-object, fixation, historical-stability, and role-separation functions.
FW-T07	Determinism Invariance	V1–V6; T01; T17	Derive a V-condition failure from determinism alone without importing an extra anti-authorship premise.
FW-T08	Branching Invariance	T04; T05; T19	Show that branch realization changes the identity fixed before branching.
FW-T09	Alternative-Possibility Non-Necessity	V1–V6; T04	Prove alternative availability is constitutive of attachment rather than envelope structure.
FW-T10	Intervention Displacement	V3; V4; V6	Show unauthorized substitution leaves the same bearer–bundle authorship relation intact.
FW-T11	No Responsibility Without Valid Commitment	D01; D07; D08; V1–V6	Provide responsibility-authorship without any valid bearer–bundle binding.
FW-T12	Coercion Defect Classification	V2–V6	Find invalidating coercion with no specified validity defect.

ID	Theorem	Principal dependencies	Counterexample condition
FW-T13	Ignorance and Bundle Identity	V2; V3; V5	Show binding to identity-relevant content without access or uptake.
FW-T14	Responsibility Prior to Sanction	D08; T04	Demonstrate that a later response constitutes the prior bearer–bundle relation.
FW-T15	Governance Legibility	D01–D10; T04	Produce stable attribution while omitting one of the five responsibility-attribution objects.
FW-T16	Delegation Non-Transfer	D01; D07; V6	Show task transfer alone creates canonical standing under the declared constraints.
FW-T17	Standing/Free-Will Non-Identity	D01; D06–D08	Show standing, capacity, exercise, and relation are extensionally identical without losing cases.
FW-T18	Constraint-Internal Freedom	D02; D03; D05–D15	Specify unconstrained authorship with a determinate object and attachment conditions, or show free uptake without validity and non-displacement.
FW-T19	Randomness Non-Authorship	D01; D06–D08	Show randomness has standing and binds itself to a determinate bundle.
FW-T20	Authorship Priority over Desert	D08; T04; T14; L09	Derive a prior bearer-bundle relation from a later response alone.
FW-T21	Same-Scope Refutation Burden	D00; T06; L01; T23	Provide one of the eight stated same-scope counterexample forms or expose internal inconsistency.
FW-T22	Final AASC Free-Will Theorem	D00–D15; T01–T26; L01–L21	Reject a premise, defeat a proof, or supply a same-scope counterexample under T21.
FW-T23	Free-Will/Responsibility Bridge	D00; D01; D06–D08; L01	Supply responsibility-authorship without a capacity-bearing author or show that causation, outcome, randomness, or reaction alone provides the bridge.
FW-T24	Conditional Form of the AASC Result	D00–D10; P1–P8; no-repair rule	Retain the AASC premises while showing that outcome-control, randomness, alternatives, reaction, or causal exception fully occupies R.
FW-T25	Desert Sequencing	D08; T04; T14; T20; L09	Supply an action-directed desert or response theory that neither identifies an authorship object nor uses a candid non-authorship basis.
FW-T26	Desert Target	D08; T04; T14; T20; T25	Supply action-directed desert, blame, punishment, excuse, mitigation, compensation, forgiveness, release, or repair with neither an authorship target nor an expressly non-authorship basis.

B.2 Bridge, comparator, and methodological lemmas

ID	Lemma	Principal dependencies	Counterexample condition
FW-L01	Responsibility-Authorship Target Adequacy	D00; target R	Show that responsibility-bearing free will can omit an R function without indeterminacy.
FW-L02	Standing Premise-Status	D01; T17	Show that stating standing as a primitive makes it identical to free will or sufficient for attribution.
FW-L03	Admissibility Non-Moralization	D02; D05; P3-P5	Show that moral or legal approval is constitutive of structural bundle identity.
FW-L04	Commitment Carrier Generality	D07; D10; V1-V5	Identify one surface form that is always sufficient and necessary for commitment across domains.
FW-L05	Structural/Factual Adjudication	V1-V6; bivalence discipline	Show that evidentiary uncertainty constitutes a third structural value or that structure alone determines contested facts.
FW-L06	Reasons-Responsiveness Insufficiency	D01; D06-D10; R	Show a reasons-responsive mechanism occupying every R function without standing, bundle, carrier, or fixation.
FW-L07	Hierarchical-Endorsement Insufficiency	V1-V5; R	Show endorsement alone supplies author eligibility, object identity, fixation, and historical stability.
FW-L08	Planning-to-Commitment	D05; D07; D10; R	Show a plan alone supplies standing, admissibility, and valid fixation across domains.
FW-L09	Reactive-Attitudes Downstream	D08; T14; T20	Show later resentment, gratitude, blame, or forgiveness constituting the prior commitment event.
FW-L10	Libertarian Authorship Conversion	D06-D09; T05; T19	Show indeterministic openness or agent-causal vocabulary supplying standing, bundle identity, carrier, and fixation without commitment.
FW-L11	Ultimate-Source Non-Requirement	T07; C03; D01-D08	Derive ultimate self-origination from the constitutive conditions of target R.
FW-L12	Action-Intention-Commitment Distinction	D06-D12; V1-V6	Show that desire, intention, choice, action, authored uptake, commitment, and execution are identical without misclassifying reflex, attempt, private intention, or delegation cases.
FW-L13	Authored Uptake	D01; D05-D12; V2-V6	Show that desire, intention, causation, or outcome alone supplies the standing-bearer's adoption of a determinate bundle as its own commitment object.
FW-L14	Commitment-Bearing Action	D07; D10-D12; V1-V6	Show that every action or intention fixes a bearer to a determinate admissible bundle, or supply commitment without a fixation relation.

ID	Lemma	Principal dependencies	Counterexample condition
FW-L15	Causal Explanation Non-Displacement	T07; D11-D12; V1-V6	Derive authorship displacement from causal explanation alone while all validity conditions remain satisfied.
FW-L16	Why This Is Still Free Will	D00; D06-D12; T23-T24	Show that responsibility-bearing free-will discourse can do its work without a capacity for authored uptake or an equivalent same-scope relation.
FW-L17	Authorship Conditions	D01-D05; D10; D14-D15; V1-V6	Show authorship arising from directed uptake without the independent standing, access, carrier, admissibility, and non-displacement conditions.
FW-L18	Positive Freedom as Valid Occupancy	D12-D15; V1-V6	Show AASC freedom with no valid indexed authorship occupancy, or reduce it to a scalar causal power.
FW-L19	Role Decomposition Necessity	D00-D15; T01	Supply a simpler same-scope vocabulary that performs all distinct functions without covert role collapse.
FW-L20	Private Carrier Fixability	D10; D14; V3-V4	Show publicity is constitutive across domains or show an unfixable private token carrying commitment without retrospective repair.
FW-L21	Evidence/Constitution Distinction	V1-V6; L05	Show an evidentiary indicator constituting standing, uptake, carrier adequacy, or commitment by category alone.
FW-L22	Omission Carrier	D05; D07; D10; D15; V2-V6	Show bare nonoccurrence attaching responsibility without an indexed duty, policy, role, undertaking, refusal, or prior commitment bundle.

Appendix C - Case Classification Matrix

The full audit workbook contains the controlled structural, evidentiary, free/will, fixation, and downstream fields. The manuscript splits them into linked tables so the archive PDF remains legible.

C.1 Structural inputs and free-will target

ID	Case	Standing	Access	Bundle	Carrier	Displacement	Free-will target	V-condition
C01	Ordinary promise	Present	Adequate	Determinate	Adequate	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1-V5
C02	Contract signature	Present/authorized	Adequate	Terms plus defaults	Authenticated	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1-V5
C03	Forged signature	Named bearer may exist	Irrelevant	Attributed bundle	Inauthentic	Forger substitutes	Carrier/authorship distinction	V4/V6
C04	Coerced signature	Present	Often adequate	Known	Voluntariness defective	Possible coercer displacement	Constraint versus coercion	V3/V4/V6
C05	Fraudulent consent	Present	Defective	B1/B2 mismatch	Formally authentic	Fraudster substitutes content	Bundle identity under fraud	V2/V5/V6
C06	Mistaken consent	Present	Incomplete	Identity may differ	Adequate form	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2/V5
C07	Unconscious movement	Retained	No current access	No new bundle	No uptake carrier	None	Standing versus current exercise	V2-V4
C08	Reflex	Retained	No uptake	No bundle	Bodily movement	None	Causation versus commitment	V3/V4
C09	Habitual skilled action	Present	Policy access	Prior policy	Trained routine	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	Prior V3-V5
C10	Child/simple promise	Present	Bundle-specific adequate	Simple	Age-appropriate	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2-V4
C11	Child/complex guarantee	Present	Likely defective	Complex	Formal token	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2/V4
C12	Severe delirium	Retained	Defective	Unstable	Unreliable	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2-V4
C13	Self-induced intoxication	Present	Varies	Layered C1/C2	Varies	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	Layered V2-V5
C14	Addiction episode	Present	Varies	Policy conflict	Varies	Mechanism may displace	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2-V6
C15	Direct implantation	Present	Bypassed	Imposed	Controlled	Manipulator displaces	Manipulation and displacement	V3/V6
C16	Persuasion	Present	Altered but available	Known	Bearer controlled	Usually none	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2/V3/V6
C17	Frankfurt blocker inactive	Present	Adequate	Actual bundle	Bearer carrier	No actual displacement	Alternative possibilities	V1-V6
C18	Frankfurt intervener active	Present	Bypassed	Substituted	Controlled	Yes	Actual intervention	V3/V6
C19	Reckless risk/no harm	Present	Adequate	Risk bundle	Deliberate	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1-V5
C20	Reckless risk/harm	Present	Adequate	Same risk bundle	Deliberate	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1-V5
C21	Failed attempt	Present	Adequate	Prohibited plan	Launch act	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1-V5
C22	Impossible attempt	Present	Relative access	Intended bundle	Launch act	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2/V5
C23	Corporate board resolution	Institutional if recognized	Adequate	Policy	Valid vote	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1/V3-V5
C24	Unauthorized employee act	Personal only	Adequate	Outside principal scope	Personal act	No principal uptake	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V1/V5/V6
C25	Automated execution	Original author presumed	At C1	Policy	System logs	No standing transfer	Delegated execution	V1/V3/V6
C26	Natural emergency	Present	Adequate	Survival bundle	Deliberate	No coercer	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	V2-V5
C27	Later revocation	Present	Adequate	New B2	Revocation token	None	Commitment-capacity and responsibility attachment	New fixation event
C28	Personal resolution	Present	Adequate	Concrete self-binding policy	Recorded or enacted resolution	None	Nonlegal commitment generality	V2-V5

ID	Case	Standing	Access	Bundle	Carrier	Displacement	Free-will target	V-condition
C29	Apology with repair undertaking	Present	Adequate	Acknowledgment plus repair/non-repetition	Authentic apology	None	Corrective commitment	V2-V5
C30	Friendship promise	Present	Adequate	Confidentiality/support bundle	Interpersonal promise and uptake	None	Interpersonal nonlegal commitment	V2-V5
C31	Moral refusal	Present	Adequate	Prohibitory non-participation policy	Refusal plus conduct	None	Commitment without positive outcome	V2-V5
C32	Artistic undertaking	Present	Adequate	Project standards and completion policy	Public or resource-backed undertaking	None	Personal project commitment	V2-V5
C33	Solemn or religious vow	Present if recognized	Adequate	Vow-defined obligation	Practice-recognized vow	None	Solemn nonlegal commitment	V1-V5
C34	Private intention without carrier	Present	Adequate	Possible intended act	No responsibility-bearing carrier	None	Intention versus commitment	V4
C35	Desire without commitment	Present	Adequate	Desired outcome only	No uptake or undertaking	None	Motivation versus commitment	V3-V5
C36	Reasons-responsive action without explicit commitment	Varies	Responsive	Behavioral policy unclear	Adaptive mechanism	None shown	Reasons-responsiveness insufficiency	V1/V3-V5
C37	Reactive blame without valid authorship object	Target may have standing	Irrelevant	No valid attributed bundle	Forged/displaced/missing carrier	Yes or unproven	Reactive attitudes downstream	V4-V6

C.2 Structural disposition and downstream reservation

ID	Structural classification	Factual adjudication needed?	Responsibility-authorship result	Downstream desert or sanction reserved
C01	Attaches	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Attaches	Performance later; desert/sanction reserved
C02	Attaches	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Attaches	Breach/damages later; desert/sanction reserved
C03	No attachment to named signer	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No attachment to named signer	Outcome cannot cure; desert/sanction reserved
C04	No apparent-bearer attachment if coercion defeats free uptake; coercer may bear displaced authorship	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No apparent-bearer transfer attachment on the stated defect facts	Benefit cannot cure; desert/sanction reserved
C05	No hidden-B2 attachment	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No hidden-B2 attachment	Outcome separate; desert/sanction reserved
C06	Depends on relevance	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Depends on relevance	Evidence later; desert/sanction reserved
C07	No new commitment	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No new commitment	Causal event only; desert/sanction reserved
C08	No current commitment	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No current commitment	Other doctrines possible; desert/sanction reserved
C09	Prior bundle may govern	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Prior bundle may govern	Execution effects; desert/sanction reserved
C10	Can attach	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Can attach	Protective rules possible; desert/sanction reserved
C11	Usually no valid uptake	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Usually no valid uptake	Enforcement separate; desert/sanction reserved
C12	No valid current token	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No valid current token	Prior commitment possible; desert/sanction reserved
C13	Layered analysis	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Layered analysis	Harm downstream; desert/sanction reserved
C14	Token-specific validity result	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Token-specific validity result	Mitigation separate; desert/sanction reserved

ID	Structural classification	Factual adjudication needed?	Responsibility-authorship result	Downstream desert or sanction reserved
C15	No imposed-bundle attachment	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	No imposed-bundle attachment	Manipulator inquiry; desert/sanction reserved
C16	Can attach	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Can attach	Influence not displacement; desert/sanction reserved
C17	Attaches	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Attaches	Alternatives irrelevant; desert/sanction reserved
C18	Apparent bearer not author	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Apparent bearer not author	Intervener inquiry; desert/sanction reserved
C19	Attaches	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Attaches	No damage outcome; desert/sanction reserved
C20	Same authorship	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Same authorship	Harm affects liability; desert/sanction reserved
C21	Attaches	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Attaches	Failure does not erase; desert/sanction reserved
C22	Can attach	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Can attach	Doctrine varies; desert/sanction reserved
C23	Institutional attachment	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Institutional attachment	Managers execute; desert/sanction reserved
C24	Personal/new relation	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Personal/new relation	Vicarious rules separate; desert/sanction reserved
C25	C ₁ policy authorship remains; local C ₂ commitment possible	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	C ₁ policy authorship remains; local C ₂ commitment possible	Output downstream; desert/sanction reserved
C26	Attaches	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	Attaches	Justification possible; desert/sanction reserved
C27	New attachment; B1 historical	Yes - token- and domain-specific evidence required	New attachment; B1 historical	Future force changes; desert/sanction reserved
C28	Valid self-binding commitment	Yes - identity and persistence evidence	Attaches to declared policy	Praise, blame, treatment, and sanction reserved
C29	Valid if uptake and bundle are genuine	Yes - sincerity and content evidence	Attaches to corrective bundle	Forgiveness and remedy reserved
C30	Valid interpersonal commitment	Yes - terms and uptake evidence	Attaches despite no legal enforcement	Blame/forgiveness reserved
C31	Valid prohibitory commitment	Yes - scope and authenticity evidence	Attaches to refusal bundle	Merit, sanction, and justification reserved
C32	Valid project commitment	Yes - specificity and carrier evidence	Attaches to project bundle	Praise, criticism, and compensation reserved
C33	Valid within indexed domain	Yes - standing, understanding, and rite evidence	Attaches if carrier conditions hold	Desert and doctrinal consequences reserved
C34	Carrier failure	Yes - whether self-binding policy exists	No attributed promise commitment	Moral appraisal of omission reserved
C35	No bundle binding	Usually yes - distinguish desire from policy	No responsibility-authorship for outcome	Praise/blame reserved
C36	Unresolved until standing and fixation shown	Yes - standing and carrier evidence	No attachment from responsiveness alone	Assessment and sanction reserved
C37	Authorship absent or unproven	Yes - source and carrier evidence	No responsibility relation created by blame	Any response requires separate basis

C.3 Free / will / fixation overlay for the five central cases

ID	Case	AASC-free condition	AASC-will condition	Authored uptake	Commitment fixation	Responsibility result
C04	Coerced signature	Fails for the transfer bundle when coercion defeats non-displacement, carrier adequacy, or uptake	Survival-oriented uptake may be authored while transfer uptake is not	Transfer uptake defective or displaced	Signature alone does not fix valid transfer commitment	No victim attachment for the transfer bundle on the stated defect facts
C14	Addiction episode	Token-specific; no scalar verdict	Identify the bundle authored in each indexed sub-token	Mixed by sub-token	Prior abstinence fixation may remain while relapse-token fixation varies	Token-specific attachment; mitigation remains downstream
C17	Frankfurt blocker inactive	Satisfied if the blocker remains inactive and V1-V6 hold	Bearer authors uptake of the actual bundle	Valid on the stated facts	Present through the bearer's carrier	Attaches despite absent alternatives
C18	Frankfurt intervener active	Fails through actual bypass or displacement	Apparent uptake is replaced by the intervener	Invalid for the apparent bearer	No valid apparent-bearer fixation	Blocked or re-indexed to the actual author
C34	Private intention without carrier	A free/unfree commitment verdict is premature	Private intention is not yet commitment-bearing authored uptake	No interpersonal uptake	Absent for the attributed promise	No interpersonal promise attachment
C38	Failure to warn after accepting safety role	Satisfied only if the prior duty bundle and warning access remain valid and non-displaced	The will condition is the accepted safety-role bundle or later refusal bundle, not the bare silence	Valid only if indexed to duty/policy uptake	Fixed by role acceptance, standing policy, or later refusal token	Attaches through indexed bundle failure, not through nonoccurrence alone

This overlay makes the semantic decomposition explicit. **Free** classifies the validity and non-displacement of uptake; **will** identifies authored bundle-adoption; **commitment** fixes that uptake; and **responsibility-authorship** is the relation attached at fixation. The complete controlled matrix in the audit workbook adds evidentiary and downstream fields for all thirty-eight cases.

Appendix D - AASC Corpus Dependency Map

D.1 Purpose and evidentiary status

The internal AASC corpus does not contain a prior complete treatment of free will at this scale. Support is distributed across standing, admissibility, bivalence, fixed-domain discipline, constraint architecture, non-selection, and governance localization. The project crosswalk identifies control-matrix rows and classifies them as direct, structural, or analogical support.

A title or keyword match is not treated as theorem proof. Where only metadata is available, the row remains a dependency lead pending primary-text verification.

D.2 Kernel support

Kernel-level materials support standing, admissibility, irreversibility, fixation, and no post-selection repair. These dependencies ground FW-D01-FW-D04 and the attachment theorem. The present treatment narrows two expressions from the seed paper: irreversibility is historical rather than perpetual, and pre-existence of the envelope is relative to fixation rather than metaphysical eternity.

D.3 Ametric and bivalence support

The AMetric Boundary, the Structure of Admissibility, the Bivalence Theorem, and metric/threshold impossibility materials support refusal of a pre-admissible scalar freedom metric. Graded evidence and domain-specific burdens are preserved while the canonical interface remains bivalent.

D.4 Constraint-architecture support

Constraint Architectures and Constraint-Bundle Forcing materials support the envelope/bundle distinction. The free-will application is specific: commitment targets a determinate bundle, while the envelope supplies boundary conditions rather than outcome selection.

D.5 Branching and non-selection support

Non-selective record-construction materials support the proposition that admissible commitment need not collapse a branch or choose actuality. Application to agency remains analogical unless the source explicitly addresses authorship.

D.6 Standing preservation and localization

Standing-Preserving Self-Improvement, Epistemic Agent Instantiation, Claim Standing and Legitimacy, Standing Localization, and related records support separation of author role from execution competence and institutional recognition. The non-delegation theorem should be rechecked against primary corpus text before external publication.

D.7 Legal and governance support

Claim-standing, legitimacy, localization, and reportability materials support the demand for a legible bearer, carrier, scope, and attachment point. They do not independently establish any positive-law doctrine in Part VI.

D.8 Dependency conclusion

The corpus contribution is convergent rather than duplicative. The paper is a new synthesis constrained by existing AASC machinery. Its strongest internal dependencies are structural rules, not scattered uses of the phrase "free will."

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